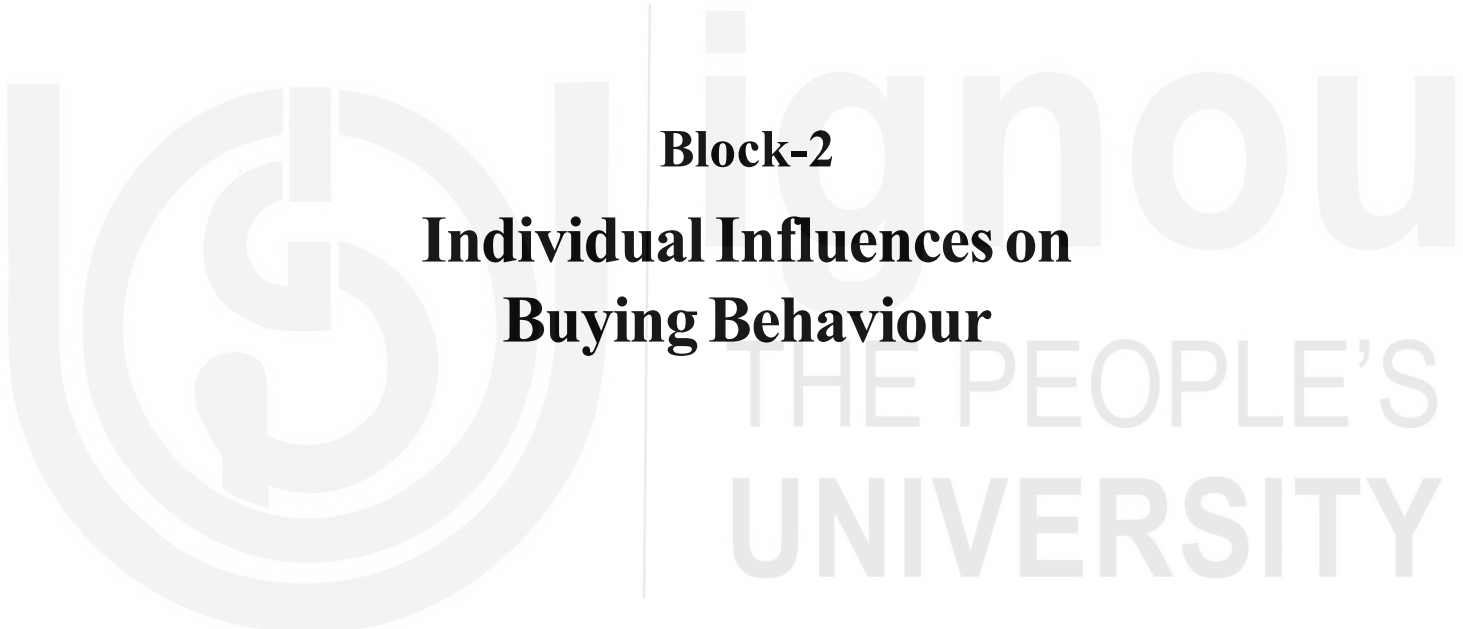




Block-2

**Individual Influences on
Buying Behaviour**

BLOCK 2 INDIVIDUAL INFLUENCES ON BUYING BEHAVIOUR

This block addresses the individual variables affecting the behaviour of people while assessing, acquiring, consuming, and evaluating goods and services. The block consists of five units on perception, learning and memory, attitude and attitude change, personality and self-concept; and consumer motivation and involvement. It builds up on the general background developed in Unit 1 of the course and deals in depth with each of the aforementioned individual variables. Project assignments to aid application of the concepts have been specially added to facilitate learning.

Unit 4 PERCEPTIONS

Unit 5 LEARNING AND MEMORY

Unit 6 ATTITUDE AND ATTITUDE CHANGE

Unit 7 PERSONALITY AND SELF-CONCEPT

Unit 8 CONSUMER MOTIVATION AND INVOLVEMENT



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UNIT 4 PERCEPTIONS

Learning outcomes

After having gone through this unit, you should be able to:

- explain the concept of perception
- describe the stages in the perceptual process
- apply the understanding of sensory, absolute and differential threshold
- describe the way subliminal perception works.

Structure

- 4.1 Introduction
- 4.2 The Concept of Perception
- 4.3 Stages in the Perceptual Process
- 4.4 Sensory System
- 4.5 Sensory Thresholds
- 4.6 Perceptual Selection
- 4.7 Summary
- 4.8 Key Words
- 4.9 Self-assessment Questions
- 4.10 Project Questions
- 4.11 Further Readings

Every new product faces a certain amount of reluctance, indifference, and resistance in the market. When the gearless scooter was introduced in the Indian market, faced, however, an unusually high share of such problems. The scooter, being gearless, was convenient to drive; better designed and more enjoyable to ride. Yet the acceptance in Indian riders was not as uniform as the company had anticipated. A certain segment of consumers and a geographical part just could not accept it. Worse, a few customers enjoyed telling their negative evaluation to the others. Their perception was that the scooter is suited for female riders, and that it might not stand the rough and tumble of Indian roads. However, with passage of time the gearless scooters are well accepted in the 2-wheeler market.

4.1 INTRODUCTION

Often, we find ourselves arguing with our friends or colleagues or family members on one issue or the other. It could be a particular advertisement or a product image or a social and political issue. The argument occurs because each one of us have point of view and we wish to hold on to it. The process of developing a viewpoint is known as perception. The study of consumer perceptions is important for marketers as buying decisions are not made on the basis of objective reality but on the basis of the perception of that reality that consumers hold in their mind.

As will be later explained (Block 4 unit 13), we are in some way like computers, when we receive inputs, process the same and then produce output. However, unlike computers, we do not passively process whatever information happens to be present. In the first place, only a very small number of the stimuli in our environment are ever noticed, of these, an even smaller amount is attended to. And the stimuli that do enter consciousness might not be processed objectively. The meaning of a stimulus is interpreted by the individual, who is influenced by his or her unique biases, needs, and experiences. All this leads to the formation of a perception. A schematic representation of the perceptual process is illustrated in Figure 4.1.

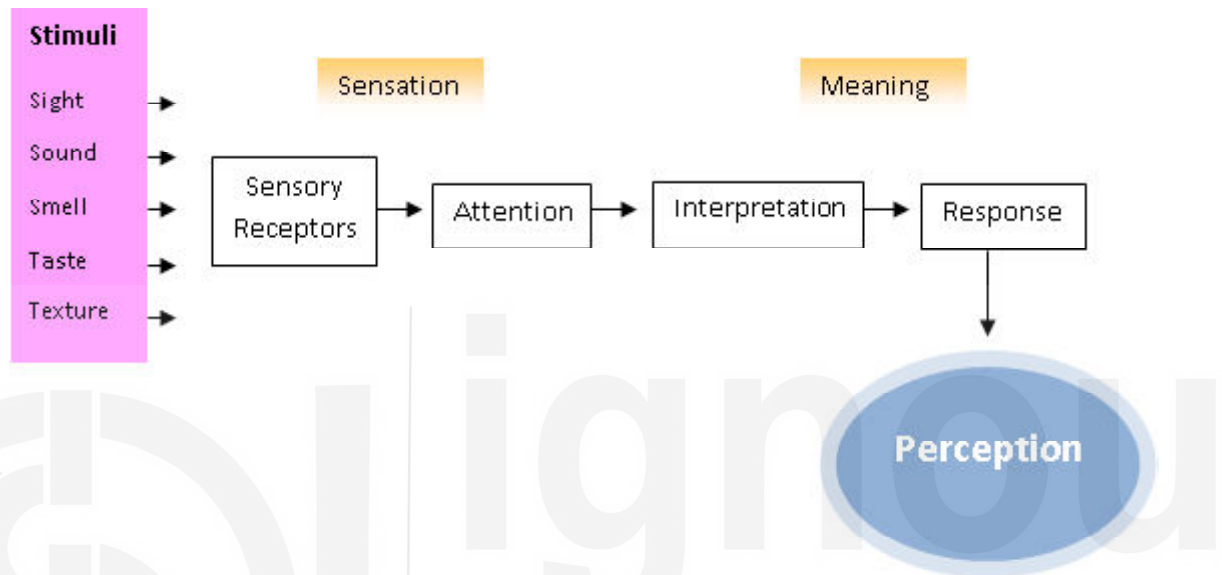


Figure 4.1 : The Perceptual Process

Activity 1

Do you see any flaws in the process of perception as portrayed in the Figure 4.1?

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4.2 THE CONCEPT OF PERCEPTION

In order to appreciate the formation of perception, it is necessary to understand sensation. Sensation is the immediate response of our sensory receptors (e.g., eyes, ears, nose, mouth, fingers) to such basic stimuli as light, color, and sound.

Perception, on the other hand, is the process by which these stimuli are selected, organized, and interpreted. Like a computer, we process raw data (sensation).

However, the study of perception focusses on what we add to or take away from these sensations as we assign meaning to them. That perception is subjective is illustrated by reaction to the Kamsutra Condoms ad campaign. It was quite a

controversial advertisement in India for the suggestive imagery and text for the message. However, some of us also saw the creative representation of what we had for traditions in India.

Activity 2

List two more features of the term perception.

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4.3 STAGES IN THE PERCEPTUAL PROCESS

No consumer forms perception in a single step. Rather, perception is an outcome of a process consisting of the following parts:

a) Primitive Categorization

Here, the basic characteristics of a stimulus are isolated by the person to form his perception. Thus, anything shining, may be seen with an amount of suspicion by the consumers. This is what is known as primitive categorization. A slight error of judgement on the part of the marketer in not appreciating this, may lead to a marketing pitfall. For instance, sample bottles of Sunlight, a dishwashing liquid in the US market, were mailed to consumers. The liquid contained 10 per cent lemon juice. Almost 80 people were treated at poison-centres after drinking some of the detergent. These individuals apparently assumed that the product was actually lemon juice, since many of the packaging cues resembled Minute Maid - a popular brand of frozen lemon juice.

b) Cue Check

Here, the cue characteristics are analyzed by the person in preparation for the selection of a schema. In the context of the sunlight liquid example quoted above, the cue check stage in the perceptual process was the pairing the yellow bottle with a prominent picture of a lemon.

c) Confirmation Check

Here, once the schema is selected, a confirmation check is run by the person to see the validity of the schema chosen. In the context of the continuing example of the Sunlight liquid detergent, a juice schema was selected instead of a dishwashing liquid schema. The confirmatory check was the picture of the lemon juice as found on the leading brand of a reveal lemon juice.

d) Confirmation Completion

The last and the final stage is confirmation completion where a perception is formed by the consumer or any person for that matter and decision is made. The act of drinking the-detergent illustrates it. Unfortunately, the consumers found out their mistake the hard way.

Activity 3

Give one Indian example similar to the one illustrated in the text and explain the stages of the perception making.

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4.4 SENSORY SYSTEM

External stimuli, or sensory inputs, can be received from a number of sources. We may see a billboard, hear a jingle, feel the softness of a cashmere sweater, taste a new flavour of ice cream, or smell a leather jacket. The inputs picket up by our five senses constitute the raw data or sensation that generates many types of responses. For example, sensory data emanating from the external environment (e.g., hearing a song on the FM radio) can generate internal sensory experiences when the song on the FM radio triggers a young man's memory of his childhood dance and brings to mind the soft feelings of the mothers' touch. Sensory inputs evoke historic imagery, in which events that actually occurred are recalled. Fantasy imagery is the result when an entirely new, imaginary experience is evoked by sensory data. These responses are an important part of hedonic consumption, or the multisensory, fantasy, and emotional aspects of consumers' interactions with products. The data that we receive from our sensory systems determine how we respond to products.

4.4.1 Vision

Marketers rely heavily on visual elements in advertising, store design, and packaging. Meanings are communicated on the visual channel through a product's size, styling, brightness, and distinctiveness from competitors. Colour is one of the most potent aspects of visual communication. Colours are rich in symbolic value and cultural meanings. For example, the display of green, white, and orange evokes feelings of patriotism for us. Such powerful cultural meanings make colour a central aspect of many marketing strategies.

4.4.2 Smell

Odours can stir emotions or create a calming feeling. They can invoke memories or relieve stress. Some of our responses to scents result from early associations with other experiences. Consumers' love of fragrances has contributed to a very large industry. The domestic flavours and fragrance market is valued at \$500 million (around 3,600 crore), a small slice of the \$24 billion global industry. Lovers of incense, loban and attars, Indians are now turning to more niche fragrances. The rise of artisanal houses such as Scentido and Maison des Parfums is a testament to the new hunger for unique perfumes. The other players include Bombay Perfumery, All Good Scents, Litrahb Perfumery, and Naso. In addition, sensory inputs like the smell of authentic leather, aroma of coffee and bakery are powerful associations with your favourite club or coffee house that may get invoked by similar aromas.

4.4.3 Sound

Music and sound are also important to marketers. For example, in case of App based mobile payment system, once transaction is officially complete, consumers hear a unique sound. When customers hear this sound, they know their purchase was finalized successfully and securely. Many aspects of sound may affect people's feelings and behaviours. Two areas of research that have widespread applications in consumer contexts are the effects of back-ground music on mood and the influence of speaking rate on attitude change and message comprehension.

4.4.4 Touch

Although relatively little research has been down on the effects of tactile stimulation on consumer behaviour, common observation tells us that this sensory channel is important. Moods are stimulated or relaxed on the basis of sensations of the skin, whether from a luxurious message or the bite of a winter wind. Sense of touch plays an important role in consumer perception, evaluation, and decision making of a product. Because of this role, many companies offer hands-on tests for their products. For example, Apple provide in-store access to its technology. This approach allowed users to touch and interact with the technology before buying. Furniture sellers, allowing customers to sit on and feel the furniture before buying, Clothes retailers provide setup to let people experience to look and feel of a garment before buying.

4.4.5 Taste

Our taste receptors obviously contribute to our experience of many products. Specialized companies called "flavour houses" keep busy trying to develop new tastes to please the changing palates of consumers. Snack brand Frito-Lay offers multiple taste variations of Cheetos, including Flamin' Hot, Puffs, White Cheddar, Chipotle Ranch, and more. Their work has been especially important as consumers continue to demand good-tasting foods that are also low in calories and fat.

Activity 4

Give one example each to illustrate these five sensory channels as described above and suggest how marketers utilise this understanding.

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4.5 SENSORY THRESHOLDS

Have you ever blown a dog whistle and watched pets respond to a sound you cannot hear? You are simply amazed by their power of sensation. The fact is that there are some stimuli that people simply are not capable of perceiving. And, of course, some people are better able to pick up sensory information than are others. The science that focuses on how the physical environment is integrated into our personal, subjective world is known as 'psychophysics'. By understanding some

of the physical laws that govern ‘what we are capable of responding to, this knowledge can be translated into marketing strategies. Thresholds work at the following levels.

4.5.1 The Absolute Threshold

When we define the lowest intensity of a stimulus that can be registered on a sensory channel, we speak of a threshold for that receptor. The absolute threshold refers to the minimum amount of stimulation that can be detected on a sensory channel. The sound emitted by a dog whistle is too high to be detected by human ears, so this stimulus is beyond our auditory absolute threshold. The absolute threshold is an important consideration in designing marketing stimuli. A billboard might have the most entertaining copy ever written, but this genius is wasted if the print is too small for passing motorists to see it from the highway.

4.5.2 The Differential Threshold

The differential threshold refers to the ability of a sensory system to detect changes or difference between two stimuli. A television commercial that is intentionally produced in black-and-white, might be noticed on a colour television because this decrease in the intensity of colour differs from the program that preceded it. The same commercial being watched on a black-and-white television would not be seen as different and might be ignored altogether. A consumer’s ability to detect a difference between two stimuli is relative. A whispered conversation that might be unintelligible on a noisy street can suddenly become public and embarrassing knowledge in a quiet library. It is the relative difference between the decibel level of the conversation and its surroundings, rather than the loudness of the conversation itself, that determines whether the stimulus will register.

4.5.3 The JND and Weber’s Law

The minimum change in a stimulus that can be detected is also known as the **JND**, which stands for just noticeable difference. In the nineteenth century, a psychophysicist named Ernest Weber found that the amount of change in stimulus that is necessary to be noticed is systematically related to the original intensity of the stimulus. The stronger the initial stimulus, the greater the change must be for it to be noticed. For example, if the price of 10 Rupee gel pen is increased by Rupees 5, it will be perceived as a significant increase. Whereas, if the price of Rupees 75, 00, 000 apartment is reduced by 5, 000 Rupees, the decrease may not be perceived. This relationship is known as **Weber’s Law**. Many companies choose to update their packages periodically, making small changes that will not necessarily be noticed at the time. When a product icon is updated, the manufacturer does not want people to lose their identification with a familiar symbol. On the other hand, whenever product improvements are made marketers would like them to be above the level of **JND** so that they are noticed and responded to.

Activity 5

Illustrate the sensory threshold concept with an example of advertisement for Two-wheelers or Four-wheelers

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4.6 PERCEPTUAL SELECTION

Although we live in an “information society,” we can have too much of a good thing. Consumers are often in a state of sensory overload, exposed to far more information than they are capable of or willing to process. People who have been in the middle of a noisy, crowded bar or party for several hours might feel the need to step outside periodically to take a break. A consumer can experience a similar overwhelmed feeling after being forced to sift through the claims made by hundreds of competing brands. Further the competition for our attention is increasing steadily. As explained in the Block 4, Unit 13, because the brain’s capacity to process information is limited, consumers are very selective about what they pay attention to.

4.6.1 Subliminal Perception

People can perceive stimuli without being consciously aware of many things, including the breath, most of the time. This process is called subliminal perception, as the stimulus is below the absolute threshold level (ATL) of our conscious awareness. The word “subliminal” literally means “below threshold.”

Subliminal perception is a topic that has captivated the public for many years, despite the fact that there is virtually no proof that this process has any effect on consumer behaviour. A survey of American consumers found that almost two-thirds believe in the existence of subliminal advertising, and over one-half are convinced that this technique can get them to buy things they do not really want. In fact, most examples of subliminal perception that have been “discovered” are not subliminal at all; they are quite visible. For example, Pepsi ran a Halloween campaign by featuring a Pepsi can in a red cape, which had Coke’s brand colours without actual logo and message as ‘We wish you a scary Halloween!’. In response to this, Coca-Cola released advertisement with the same picture that was advertised by Pepsi by adding Coke logo and mocked Pepsi by saying that ‘Everybody wants to be a hero!’. Remember, if you can see it or hear it, it is not subliminal because the stimulus, by definition has to be above the level of conscious awareness! Nonetheless, the continuing controversy about subliminal persuasion has been important in shaping the public’s beliefs about advertising and marketers’ ability to manipulate consumers against their will. The public’s fear of unconscious manipulation, began with a widely popularized experiment that was performed in a New Jersey drive - in movie theatre in September 1957. During a showing of the movie Picnic, a firm called the Subliminal Projection Company inserted messages that said “Drink Coco-Cola” and “Eat Popcorn” for 1/3000 second every five seconds.’ This rate was too fast for viewers to be aware that they had seen the images. Supposedly, sales of popcorn increased by almost 58 per cent and consumption of Coke grew by almost 18 per cent. The design of the study was flawed in that other possible effects on consumption, such as the movie itself, the weather during the showing, and so on, could not be ruled out. Indeed, the executive responsible for the test later admitted that he had made up results to revive his failing research firm. Despite the many studies of subliminal

persuasion, there is no evidence that subliminal advertising persuades people to buy goods or services, and that most of its effects were researched in highly artificial situations. However, there is tangential indication that subliminal advertising may reduce anti-social behavior, such as that subliminal antishoplifting messages broadcasted in malls may lower shoplifting rates.

Activity 6

Give one example of the subliminal perception concept application that may be used by Indian marketers

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4.6.2 Subliminal Techniques

Subliminal perceptions can be formed through several routes. The following are some techniques:

a) Embeds

Embeds are tiny figures that are often inserted into print advertising by use of high-speed photography or airbrushing. These hidden figures, usually of a sexual nature, supposedly exert strong but unconscious influences on innocent readers. Ice cubes are a prime culprit for accusations of this type of subliminal persuasion. Critics often focus on ambiguous shapes in drinks as evidence for the use of this technique. For instance, one ad of the Gilbey's Gin contains letters S E X are spelled out in the ice cubes. The other example of embeds is a hidden dollar in the KFC sandwich that links it to power and wealth

b) Auditory Messages

In addition to subliminal visual messages, many consumers and marketers seem to be fascinated by the possible effects of messages hidden on sound recordings. An attempt to capitalize on subliminal auditory perception techniques is found in the growing market for self-help audiobooks. These audiobooks, which typically feature the sound of waves crashing or some other natural setting, supposedly contain subliminal messages to help the listener stop smoking, lose weight, gain confidence, and so on. There are two types of auditory subliminal messages are further classified as sub audible and backmasking messages. Sub audible messages are low-volume messages inserted into louder audio files so that they cannot be heard. Whereas, Backmasking is a video message recorded backwards so that the original message is disguised when playing it forward. Despite the rapid growth of this market, there is little evidence that subliminal stimuli transmitted on the auditory channel can bring about desired changes in behaviour.

c) Consumer Folklore

Along with the interest in hidden self-help messages on recordings, some consumers have become concerned about marketing rumours, also called as the consumer

folklore, of satanic messages recorded backward on rock records. The popular press has devoted much attention to such stories, and state legislatures have considered bills requiring warning labels about these messages. These backward messages do indeed appear on some albums, including Led Zeppelin's classic song "Stairway to Heaven," which contains the lyric "...there's still time to change." When played in reverse, this phrase sounds like "so here's to my sweet Satan." The novelty of such reversals might help to sell records, but the "evil" messages within have no effect. Humans do not have a speech perception mechanism operating at an unconscious level that is capable of decoding a reversed signal.

d) Low Level Auditory Stimulation

One technique, known as 'psycho-acoustic persuasion', does appear to work. Subtle acoustical messages such as "I am honest. I won't steal. Stealing is dishonest" are broadcast in more than 1000 stores in the United States to prevent shoplifting. Unlike subliminal perception, though, these messages are played at a (barely) audible level, using a technique known as threshold messaging. After a nine-month test period, theft losses in one six-store chain declined almost 40 per cent, saving the company \$600,000. To conclude, some evidence indicates, however, that these messages are effective only on individuals whose value systems make them predisposed to suggestion. For example, someone who might be thinking about taking something on a dare but who feels guilty about it might be susceptible to these messages, but they will not sway, a professional thief or a kleptomaniac.

Activity 7

Give one example of the techniques used in India for creating subliminal perception.

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4.7 SUMMARY

The unit is the initial unit of the block on individual influences on consumer behaviour and focuses attention on the perception process. It defines perception as the process of selecting, organizing and interpreting the stimuli to make a picture or a viewpoint. Perception is a subjective view of the world. It is heavily dependent upon the process of information processing and learning as explained in the unit 5 and unit 13 on information processing. A detailed analysis is made of the stages in perception and the subliminal perception, a controversial issue in consumer behaviour.

4.8 KEY WORDS

- Differential threshold** : The minimum amount of stimulation that can indicate if there is a change in the input in a sensory channel.
- Embeds** : Tiny Figures that are inserted into the messages by use of high-speed photography or airbrushing, with an objective to influence sub-consciously.

4.9 SELF-ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

1. What is meant by consumer perception? How do you justify the relevance of studying perceptions when they may not accurately reflect reality? Give an example to illustrate your answer.
2. Illustrate the stages of perception with a real or imaginary example.
3. How does the sense of touch influence consumers' reactions to products?
4. Discuss the differences between the absolute threshold and the differential threshold. Which one is more important to marketers and why? Explain.
5. Why consumers process only a small amount of the information they receive? Explain
6. What is meant by subliminal persuasion? What strategies are available to us in this regard?
7. Does subliminal perception work? Why or why not?

4.10 PROJECT QUESTIONS

- 1) Select three ads that you like most and have understood them well. Now, show these to your friend and ask what they think of them. Report if their perception meets yours or not. Try to explain the variance or agreement in this respect.
- 2) Choose one of your favourite products that you have been buying for some years. How has it changed over the years?

4.11 FURTHER READINGS

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UNIT 5 LEARNING AND MEMORY

Learning outcomes

After going through this unit, you should be able to

- explain how learning differs from other forms of communication
- describe what shapes the learning styles.
- discuss how consumers retrieve or recall information or how the memory work
- apply the knowledge of key principles that can be remembered and used by us in your marketing decisions.

Structure

- 5.1 Introduction
- 5.2 Concept of Learning
- 5.3 Theories of Learning
- 5.4 The Two Complex Issues of Learning
- 5.5 Memory: Structure and Functioning
- 5.6 Retrieving Information
- 5.7 Measuring Memory for Advertising
- 5.8 Marketing Applications
- 5.9 Summary
- 5.10 Key Words
- 5.11 Self-Assessment Questions
- 5.12 Project Questions
- 5.13 Further Readings

The use of the term avatar for the on-screen representation of the user was coined by Richard Garriott for the computer game Ultima IV: Quest of the Avatar. Now a days, avatars are common in web forums. Users of online discussion forums are usually required to register and provide information about themselves. For example, in online communities, such as Second Life and The Sims Online. Once a user has created an avatar, he or she becomes part of an online community filled with other users' avatars. Players can interact with other avatars and talk to them using text or voice chat. So, what exactly does this imply for marketers? many things. Avatars interact with real brands in these virtual worlds. They can purchase products such as t shirt for their avatars, and they can attend events such as conferences or shows. Marketers have realised that how the people's virtual behaviour influences the way they learn about brands. Avatars are used in many corporate websites to interact with visitors, to greet and guide them. According to research, these avatars may improve user satisfaction and influence purchases. All such presentations show the application of learning theories and constructs in an imagined reality that is strongly influenced by what we know of learning behaviour.

5.1 INTRODUCTION

The key difference between a human being and an animal is the ability of the former to make a systematic and applied learnt response. Thus, most of our behaviour is consistent as well as cognitive even though the stimuli or the circumstances differ. We can vary our responses even to the same situations or same response to different situations. All this happens because the human beings acquire new experiences as well inputs and tend to replace the instinctive behaviour - a characteristic of animal behaviour, with these inputs. Thus, even though there is a new advertisement or a new product, of which we may have no prior exposure, we know how to deal with it. We can also recall our own experience or happenings through the use of the memory to shape our behaviour.

Learning and memory are very powerful tools for seeking behaviour modification.

5.2 CONCEPT OF LEARNING

Learning refers to a relatively permanent change in behaviour that is caused by experience. A more detailed definition of learning is when it is viewed “as a process in which behavioural capabilities are changed as result of experience provided the change cannot be accounted for by native response tendencies, maturation or any temporary states of the organism due to fatigue, drugs, or any other temporary factors”

The key words of the definition are: process; behavioural capabilities; and an enduring change. Thus, learning is not an act, it is not the behaviour but the capability to behave and the permanency of the change through the experience.

This experience does not have to be acquired directly by the learner. He can learn vicariously too - by observing events that affect others. He also learns even when he is not trying. Consumers recognize many brand names and can hum many product jingles, for example, even for those product categories they themselves do not use. This casual, unintentional acquisition of knowledge is known as incidental learning. Like the concepts of perception discussed in the last unit, learning is a process. Our knowledge about the world, is constantly being revised as we are exposed to new stimuli and receive ongoing feedback that allows us to modify behaviour in other similar situations.

Another interesting fact about the learning is that it covers a lot of ground, ranging from a consumer's simple association between a stimulus such as a product logo (e.g., Amul) and a response (e.g., “Taste of India”) to a complex series of cognitive activities (e.g., using the washing machine).

Activity 1

Define learning of new skills like driving in your own words. Which of the types of learning it conforms to?

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5.3 THEORIES OF LEARNING

Psychologists offer several theories to explain the learning process. These theories range from those focusing on simple stimulus-response connections to perspectives that regard consumers as complex problem solvers who learn abstract rules and concepts by observing others or observing phenomena that unfold before them.

5.3.1 Classical Conditioning

Classical conditioning occurs when a stimulus that elicits a response, is paired with another stimulus that initially does not elicit a response on its own. Over time, this second stimulus causes a similar response because it is associated with the first stimulus. This phenomenon was first demonstrated in dogs by Ivan Pavlov, a Russian physiologist doing research on digestion in animals. Pavlov conducted a number of conditioning trials by pairing a neutral stimulus (a bell) with a stimulus known to cause a salivation response in dogs (he squirted dried meat powder into their mouths). The powder was an unconditioned stimulus (UCS) because it was naturally capable of causing the response. Overtime, the bell became a conditioned stimulus (CS). It did not initially cause salivation, but the dogs learned to associate the bell with the meat powder and began to salivate at the sound of the bell only. The drooling of these canine consumers over a bell sound, now linked to feeding time, was a conditioned response (CR).

Classical conditioning can have similar effects for more complex reactions, too. Even a credit card becomes a conditioned cue that triggers greater spending, especially since it is a stimulus that is present only in situations where consumers are spending money. People learn they can make larger purchases when using credit cards, and they also have been found to leave larger tips than when using cash.

Activity 2

Describe an ad that is based on learning through classical conditioning.

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The following are some very important principles of classical conditioning of great use to a marketer.

- a) **Repetition:** Conditioning effects are more likely to occur after the conditioned stimuli have been paired a number of times. Repeated exposures increase the strength of stimulus-response associations and prevent the decay of these associations in memory.

Many classic advertising campaigns consist of product slogans that have been repeated so many times that they are etched in consumers' minds (remember the "two minutes Noodles"!) Conditioning will not occur or will take longer if the conditioned stimulus is only occasionally presented with the unconditioned stimulus. One result of this

lack of association may be extinction, which occurs when the effects of prior conditioning are reduced and finally disappear.

- b) **Stimulus Generalization:** Stimulus generalization refers to the tendency of stimuli to a CS to evoke similar, conditioned responses. For example, Pavlov noticed in subsequent studies that his dogs would sometimes salivate when they heard noises that only resembled a bell (e.g., keys jangling). People react to other, similar stimuli in much the same way they responded to the original stimulus. Marketers use this concept to create and sell “me too” type of products with similar sounding names or package colouring, very close to the market leader.
- c) **Stimulus Discrimination:** Stimulus discrimination occurs when a stimulus similar to a CS is not followed by a UCS. When this happens, reactions are weakened and will soon disappear. Part of the learning process involves making a response to some stimuli but not to other, similar stimuli. Manufacturers of well-established brands commonly urge consumers not to buy “cheap imitations”, because the results will not be what they expect even seeking to provide cues to distinguish the original brand from cheap copies.

5.3.2 Operant Conditioning

Operant conditioning, also known as instrumental conditioning, occurs as the individual learns to perform behaviours that produce positive outcomes and to avoid those that yield negative outcomes. This learning process is most closely associated with the psychologist B.F. Skinner, who demonstrated the effects of instrumental conditioning by teaching animals to dance, play ping-pong, and so on by systematically rewarding them for desired behaviours.

While responses in classical conditioning are involuntary and fairly simple, those in instrumental conditioning are made deliberately to obtain a goal and may be more complex. The desired behaviour may be learned over a period of time, as intermediate actions are rewarded in a process called shaping. For example, the owner of a new store may award prizes to shoppers just for coming in, hoping that over time they will continue to drop in and eventually buy something. A good way to remember the difference is to keep in mind that in instrumental learning, the response is performed because it is instrumental to gaining a reward or avoiding a punishment. Consumers over time come to associate with people that reward them and to choose products that make them feel good or satisfy some need.

Instrumental learning occurs in one of the following ways. When the environment provides positive reinforcement in the form of a reward, the response is strengthened, and appropriate behaviour is learned. For example, a woman who gets compliments after wearing a particular brand of perfume, will learn that using this product has the desired effect, and she will be more likely to keep buying the product. Negative reinforcement also strengthens responses so that appropriate behaviour is learned. A foot-wear manufacturer ran an ad showing a woman in embarrassment as her slipper broke off in the middle of the market. The message is that she could have avoided this negative outcome if only she had used the manufactures brand of footwear.

Activity 3

Describe an ad that is based on instrumental type of learning. Also explain the way in which learning is shown to occur

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The instrumental learning is based on several outcomes. Figure 5.1 exhibits the four types of learning outcomes. An important factor in operant conditioning is the issue of appropriate reinforcements. The answer to the question-what is the most effective reinforcement schedule, is important to marketers because it relates to the amount of effort and resources, they must devote to rewarding consumers in order to condition desired behaviours. The following reinforcement schedules normally are suggested in the literature:

- a) **Fixed-interval reinforcement:** After a specified time period has passed, the first response that is made brings the reward. Under such conditions, people tend to respond slowly right after being reinforced, but their responses speed up as the time for the next reinforcement looms.

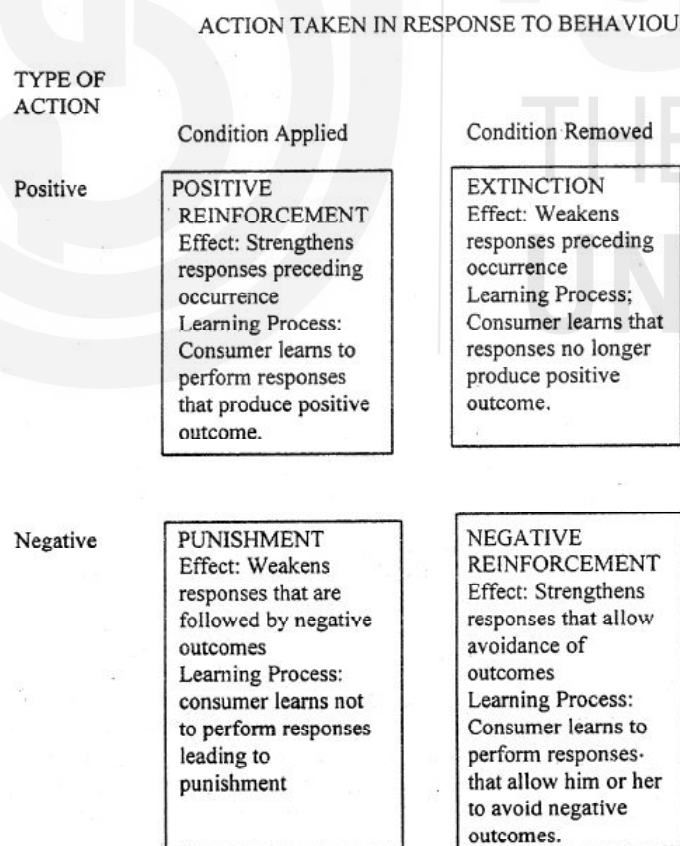


Figure 5.1 : Four Types of Learning Outcomes

- b) **Variable-interval reinforcement:** Here the time that must pass before reinforcement is delivered is allowed to vary. The attempt is expected to bring an element of surprise as well as an air of expectancy.

- c) **Fixed-ratio reinforcement:** As against the above, here the reinforcement occurs in a fixed ratio.
- d) **Variable-ratio reinforcement:** The behaviour is reinforced after a certain number of responses, but the consumer does not know how many responses are required. People in such situations tend to respond at very high and steady rates, and this type of behaviour is very difficult to extinguish.

Activity 4

Suggest which of the two schedules - the fixed ratio or the variable ratio reinforcement schedule will be suitable for advertising opening of a new departmental store. State your assumptions also.

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5.3.3 Cognitive Learning Theory

Cognitive learning explains learning as a result of mental processes. In contrast to behavioural theories of learning, cognitive learning theory stresses the importance of internal mental processes. This perspective views people as problem solvers who actively use information from the world around them to master their environment. Supporters of this viewpoint also stress the role of creativity and insight during the learning process. The cognitive theory explanations of learning are strongly based on memory, memory processes as described later:

Activity 5

Describe one of your own learning experiences that is based on cognitive learning.

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5.4 THE TWO COMPLEX ISSUES OF LEARNING

5.4.1 The Issue of Consciousness

A lot of controversy surrounds the issue of whether or when people are aware of their learning processes. While behavioural learning theorists emphasize the routine, automatic nature of conditioning, proponents of cognitive learning argue that even these simple effects are based on cognitive factors. On the other hand, there is some evidence for the existence of non-conscious procedural knowledge. People apparently do process at least some information in an automatic, passive way, which

is a condition that has been termed mindlessness. When we meet someone new or encounter a new product, for example, we have a tendency to respond to the stimulus in terms of existing categories, rather than taking the trouble to formulate different ones. Our reactions are activated by a trigger feature, some stimulus that cues us toward a particular pattern. For example, the presence of a doctor in a message about the tooth paste, prompted the consumers to rate the product superior although none of them ever consulted a dentist before they bought their tooth paste. Nonetheless, many modern theorists are beginning to regard some instances of conditioning as cognitive processes, especially where expectations are formed about the linkages between stimuli and responses. Indeed, studies using masking effects, where it is difficult for subjects to learn CS/ UCS associations; show substantial reductions in conditioning. For example, an adolescent girl may observe that women on television and in real life seem to be rewarded with compliments and attention when they smell nice and wear alluring clothing. She figures out that the probability of these rewards occurring is greater when she wears perfume, and deliberately wears a popular scent to obtain the payoff of social acceptance.

5.4.2 Observational Learning

Observational learning occurs when people watch the actions of others and note the reinforcements they receive for their behaviours. This type of learning is a complex process. People store these observations in memory as they accumulate knowledge, perhaps using this information at a later point to guide their own behaviour. This process of imitating the behaviour of others is called modelling. For example, a 'woman shopping for a new kind of perfume may remember the reaction her friend received upon wearing a certain brand several months earlier, and she will base her, behaviour on her friend's actions.

In order for observational learning in the form of modelling to occur, four conditions must be met. These factors are summarized in Figure 5.2.

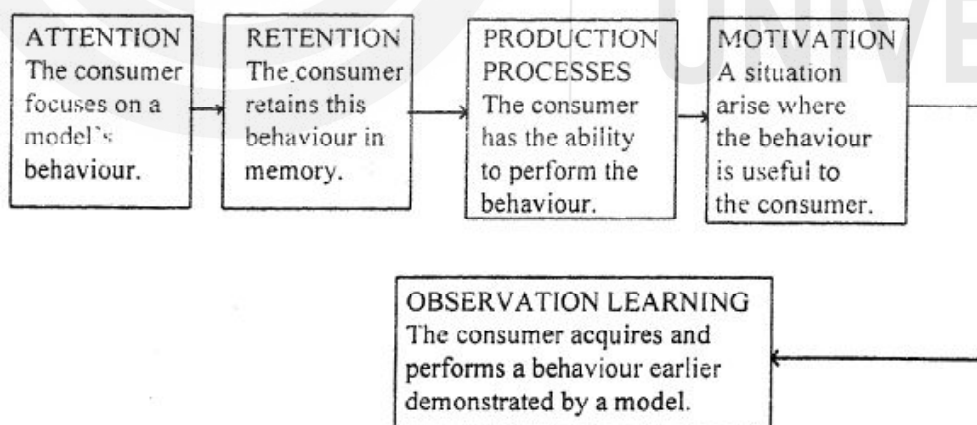


Figure 5.2 Components of Observational Learning

- a) The consumer's attention must be directed to the appropriate model, who for reasons of attractiveness, competence, status, or similarity is desirable to emulate.
- b) The consumer must remember what is said or done by the model.
- c) The consumer must convert this information into actions.
- d) The consumer must be motivated to perform these actions.

Activity 6

Explain in your words the operation and the value of the Figure 5.2. in explaining observational learning. Also, narrate your own example of recent observational learning.

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5.5 MEMORY: STRUCTURE AND FUNCTIONING

Memory involves a process of acquiring information and storing it over time so that it will be available when needed. Contemporary approaches to the study of memory employ an information-processing approach. They assume that the mind is in some ways like a computer, data are input, processed, and output for later use in revised form. In the encoding stage, information is entered in a way the system will recognize. In the storage stage, this knowledge is integrated with what is already in memory and “warehoused” until needed. During retrieval, the person accesses the desired information. The memory process is summarized in Figure 5.3.

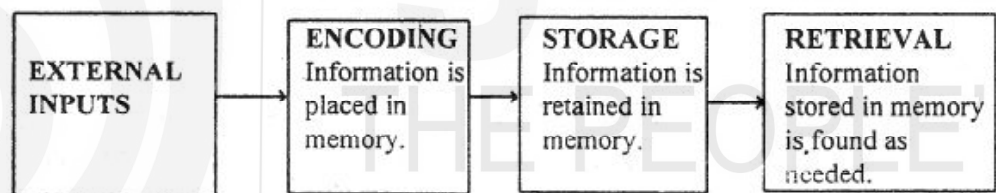


Figure 5.3 The Memory Process

According to the information-processing approach, there are three distinct memory systems: sensory memory, short-term memory (STM), and long-term memory (LTM). Each plays a role in processing brand-related information. The interrelationships of these memory systems are summarized in Figure 5.4.

- a) **The Sensory memory** permits storage of the information we receive from our senses. This storage is very temporary; it lasts a couple of seconds at most. For example, a person might be walking past a pastry shop and get a quick, enticing whiff of something baking inside. While this sensation would only last for a few seconds, it would be sufficient to allow the person to determine if he or she should investigate further. If the information is retained for further processing, it passes through an attentional gate and is transferred to short-term memory.
- b) **Short-term memory** also stores information for a limited period of time, and its capacity is limited. Similar to a computer, this system can be regarded as working memory; it holds the information we are currently processing. Verbal input may be stored acoustically (in terms of how it sounds) or semantically (in terms of its meaning). The information is stored by combining small pieces into larger ones in a process known as “chunking.” A chunk

is a configuration that is familiar to the person and can be manipulated as a unit. For example, a brand name can be a chunk that summarizes a great deal of detailed information about the brand.

- c) **Long-term memory** is the system that allows us to retain information for a long period of time. In order for information to enter into long-term memory from short-term memory, elaborate rehearsal is required. This process involves thinking about the meaning of a stimulus and relating it to other information already in memory. Marketers sometimes assist in the process by devising catchy slogans or jingles that consumer repeat on their own. Remember the catchy tune of Amul Doodh Peeta hai India, or the long uses slogan of tandarusti ki raksha karta hai Lifebuoy and you will be able to appreciate the role of repetition in reinforcing consumer memory.

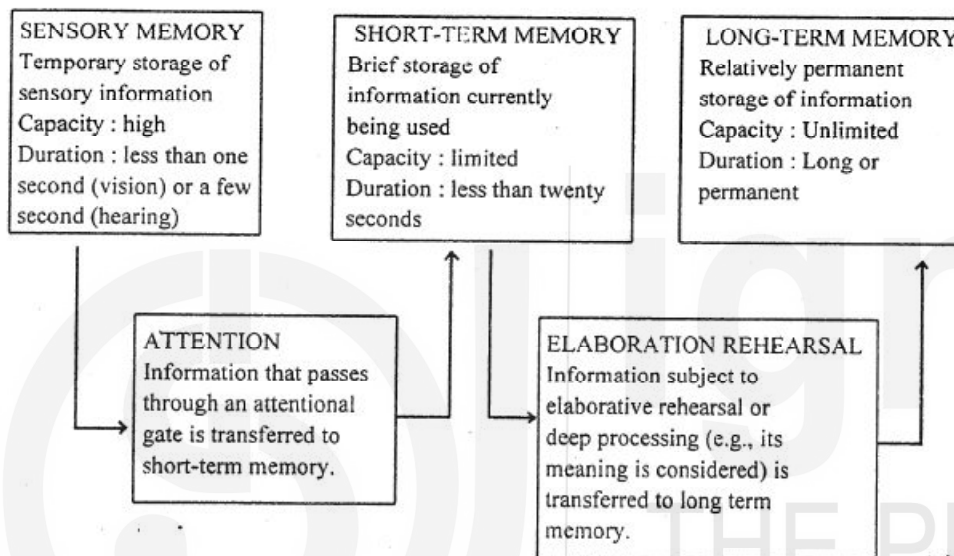


Figure 5.4 : Relationships among Memory Systems

Activity 7

Explain in your words the operation and the value of the Figure 5.4.

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5.6 RETRIEVING INFORMATION

Retrieval is the process whereby information is accessed or retrieved from long-term memory. People have a vast quantity of information stored in their heads that is not necessarily available on demand. Although most of the information entered in long-term memory does not go away, it may be hard or impossible to retrieve unless the appropriate cues are present.

- a) **Factors Influencing Retrieval.** Some differences in retrieval ability are physiological. Older adults consistently display inferior recall ability for current

items such as prescription information, though events that happened to them why they were younger may be recalled with great clarity. Other factors are situational, relating to the environment in which the message is delivered. Not surprisingly recall is enhanced when the consumer pays more attention to the message in the first place. Some evidence indicates that information about a pioneering brand (the first brand to enter a market) is more easily retrieved from memory than follower brands because the product's introduction is likely to be distinctive and, for the time being, no competitors divert the consumer's attention. In addition, descriptive brand names are more likely to be recalled than are those that do not provide adequate cues as to what the product is.

- b) **State-Dependent Retrieval.** In a process termed state-dependent retrieval, people are better able to access information if their internal state is the same at the time of recall as when the information was learned. This phenomenon is called the mood congruence effect. The fact underscores the desirability of matching a consumer's mood at the time of purchase when planning exposure to marketing communications. A consumer is more likely to recall an ad, for example, if his or her mood or level of arousal at the time of exposure is similar to that in the purchase environment. By recreating the cues that were present when the information was first presented, recall can be enhanced. For example, Parle G uses a picture of a cute little girl on its packaging as well as the advertisement. It intends to facilitate recall of brand claims and favourable brand evaluations.
- c) **Familiarity.** As a general rule, prior familiarity with an item enhances its recall. Indeed, this is one of the basic goals of marketers who are trying to create and maintain awareness of their products. The more experience a consumer has with a product, the better use he or she is able to make of product information. However, there is a possible exception to the rule. Evidence indicates that extreme familiarity can result in inferior learning and/or recall. When consumers are highly familiar with a brand or an advertisement, they may attend to fewer attributes because they do not believe that any additional effort will yield a gain in knowledge. For example, when consumers are exposed to the technique of radio replay, where the audio track from a television ad is replayed on the radio, they do very little critical, evaluative processing and instead mentally replay the video portion of the ad.
- d) **Salience.** The salience of a brand refers to its prominence or level of activation in memory. Stimuli that stand out in contrast to their environment are more likely to command attention, which in turn, increases the likelihood they will be recalled. Almost any technique that increases the novelty of a stimulus also improves recall (a result known as the von Restorff effect). This effect explains why unusual advertising or distinctive packaging tend to facilitate brand recall.
- e) **Pictorial versus Verbal Cues.** There is some evidence for the superiority of visual memory over verbal memory, but this advantage is unclear because it is more difficult to measure recall of pictures. However, the available data indicate that information presented in picture form is more likely to be recognized later. Certainly, visual aspects of an ad are more likely to

grab a consumer's attention. In fact, eye-movement studies indicate that about 90 per cent of viewers look at the dominant picture in an ad before they bother to view the copy. One study found that television news items presented with illustration (still pictures) as a backdrop result in improved recall for details of the new story, even though understanding of the story's content does not improve.

Activity 8

Can you think of any more factors that in your view, assist the retrieval of information from the memory? Use your experience of trying to recall information that you are sure you have read or heard about and are trying to retrieve now. Think about what factors played a role when the recall was easily made. Comment upon them if your experience suggests factors other than those shared above.

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5.7 MEASURING MEMORY FOR ADVERTISING

Because advertisers pay so much money to place their messages in front of consumers, they are naturally concerned that people will actually remember these messages at a later point. It seems that they have good reason to be concerned. In one study, less than 40 per cent of television viewers made positive links between commercial messages and the corresponding products, only 65 per cent noticed the brand name in a commercial, and only 38 per cent recognized a connection to an important point. Even more sadly, only 7 per cent of television viewers can recall the product or company featured in the most recent television commercial they watched. This figure represents less than half the recall rate recorded in 1965, and may be attributed to such factors as the increase of 30- and 15-second commercials and the practice of airing television commercials in clusters rather than in single-sponsor programs. However, in case of online marketing messages, research done by Google found that recall improves when spots reappear before YouTube videos. Similar results were also reported by Apple for "iAds," mobile ads that pop up on iPhones and iPods.

5.7.1 Recognition versus Recall

One indicator of good advertising is, of course, the impression it makes on consumers. But how can this impact be defined and measured? Two basic measures of impact are recognition and recall. In the typical recognition test, subjects are shown ads one at a time and asked if they have seen them before. In contrast, free recall tests ask consumers to independently produce previously acquired information and then perform a recognition check on it. Under some conditions, these two memory measures tend to yield the same results, especially when the researchers try to keep the viewers' interest in the ads constant. Generally, though, recognition scores tend to be more reliable and do not decay over time the way recall scores do. Recognition scores

are almost always better than recall scores because recognition is a simpler process and more retrieval cues are available to the consumer.

Both types of retrieval play important roles in purchase decisions. Recall tests tend to be more important in situations where consumers do not have product data at their disposal, and so they must rely upon memory to generate this information. On the other hand, recognition is more likely to be an important factor in a store, where consumers are confronted with thousands of product options and information (i.e., external memory is abundantly available) and the task may simply be to recognize a familiar package. For example, the Maharajah of the Air India icon was quickly recognized by the consumers. However, recent research shows that technology aided instant information retrieval or checking through internet search has weakened the consumer tendency to rely on memory recall. A simple example is also recall of telephone numbers- our dependence and ease of using contact lists on our phones has eroded the tendency to recall familiar phone numbers

5.7.2 Problems with Memory Measures

While the measurement of an ad's memorability is important, the ability of existing measures to accurately assess these dimensions has been criticized for several reasons.

- a) **Response Biases.** Results obtained from a measuring instrument are not necessarily due to what is being measured, but rather to something else about the instrument or the respondent. This form of contamination is called a response bias. For example, people tend to give yes responses to questions, regardless of what is asked. In addition, consumers often have an eagerness to be "good subjects" by pleasing the experimenter. They will try to give the responses they think he or she is looking for. In some studies, the claimed recognition of bogus ads (ads that have not been seen before) is almost as high as the recognition rate of real ads.
- b) **Memory Lapses.** Typical problems include omitting (leaving facts out), averaging (the tendency to "normalize" things and not report extreme cases), and telescoping (inaccurate recall of time). These distortions call into question the accuracy of various product usage data bases that rely upon consumers to recall their purchase and consumption of food and household items. In one study, for example, people were asked to describe what portion of various foods-small, medium, or large they ate in a normal meal. However, different definitions of "medium" were used (e.g., 3/4 cup versus 1 1/2 cup). Regardless of the measurement used, about the same number of people claimed they normally ate medium portions.
- c) **Memory versus Feeling.** Although techniques are being developed to increase the accuracy of memory scores, these improvements do not address the more fundamental issue of whether recall is necessary for advertising to have an effect. In particular, some critics argue that these measures do not adequately, tap the impact of "feeling" ads where the objective is to arouse strong emotions rather than to convey concrete product benefits. Many ad campaigns, including those for Hallmark cards, Chevrolet, and Pepsi use this approach. An effective strategy relies on a long-term build-up of feeling rather than on a one-shot attempt to convince consumers to buy the product.

Activity 9

Can you think of any more factors that in your view, assist the measuring the memory for advertising?

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5.8 MARKETING APPLICATIONS

Understanding how consumers learn is very important to marketers. After all, many strategic decisions are based on the assumption that consumers are continually accumulating information about products and that people can be “taught” to prefer some alternative over others. Also, that consumers use ads to reinforce their positive product experiences and even use new information about an added ingredient or improved safety feature to “edit” memory of earlier product experience.

5.8.1 Repetition

One advertising researcher argues that more than three exposures are wasted. The first creates awareness of the product, the second demonstrates its relevance to the consumer, and the third serves as a reminder of the product’s benefits. However, even this bare-bones approach implies that repetition is needed to ensure that the consumer is actually exposed to (and processes) the ad at least three times. Marketers attempting to condition an association must ensure that the consumers they have targeted will be exposed to the stimulus a sufficient number of times.

On the other hand, it is possible to have too much of a good thing: Consumers can become so used to hearing or seeing a marketing stimulus that they no longer pay attention to it. This problem, known as advertising wear out, can be alleviated by varying the way in which the basic message is presented.

5.8.2 Conditioning Product Associations

Advertisements often pair a product with a positive stimulus to create a desirable association. Various aspects of a marketing message, such as music, humour, or imagery, can affect conditioning. In one study, for example, subjects who viewed a slide of pens paired with either pleasant or unpleasant music were more likely to later select the pen that appeared with pleasant music. The order in which the conditioned stimulus and the unconditioned stimulus is presented can affect the likelihood that learning will occur. Generally speaking, the conditioned stimulus should be presented prior to the unconditioned stimulus. The technique of conditioning, such showing a soft drink (the UCS) and then playing a jingle (the CS) is generally not effective.

Because sequential presentation is desirable for conditioning to occur, classical conditioning is not very effective in static situations, such as in magazine ads, where

(in contrast to TV, radio, or digital media) the marketer cannot control the order in which the CS and the UCS are perceived.

Just as product associations can be formed, they can extinguish. Because of the danger of extinction, a classical conditioning strategy may not be as effective for products that are frequently encountered, since there is no guarantee, they will be accompanied by the CS. A bottle of soft drink paired with the refreshing sound of a carbonated beverage being poured over ice may seem like a good example of conditioning. Unfortunately, the product would also be seen in many other contexts where this sound was absent, reducing the effectiveness of the conditioning.

By the same reasoning, a novel tune should be chosen over a popular one to pair with a product, since the popular song might also be heard in many situations where the product is not present. Music videos in particular may serve as effective UCSs because they often have an emotional impact on viewers, and this effect may transfer to ads accompanying the video.

5.8.3 Stimulus Generalization

The process of stimulus generalization is often central to branding and packaging decisions that attempt to capitalize on consumers' positive associations with an existing brand or company name. In one twenty-month period, Proctor & Gamble introduced almost ninety new products. Not a single one carried a new brand name. In fact, roughly 80 per cent of all new products are actually extensions of existing brands or product lines. Strategies based on stimulus generalization include the following.

- a) **Family branding**, where a variety of products capitalize on the reputation of a company name. Companies such as Tata rely on their positive corporate images to sell different product lines.
- b) **Product line extensions**, where related products are added to an established brand. Tata salt, Tata Black Salt, Tata Rock salt, Tata Sampanna spices etc. under the same brand name.
- c) **Licensing**, where well-known names are "rented" by others. This strategy is increasing in popularity as marketers try to link their products and services with well-established figures. The Disney Characters and the companies as diverse as McDonald's have authorized the use of their names on products.
- d) **Look-alike packaging**, where distinctive packaging designs create strong associations with a particular brand. This linkage often is exploited by makers of generic or private-label brands who wish to communicate a quality image by putting their products in very similar packages.
- e) **Reinforcement of Consumption**. Marketers have many ways to reinforce consumers, ranging from a simple thank you after a purchase to substantial rebates and follow-up phone calls or email messages. For example, a life insurance company obtained a much higher rate of policy renewal among a group of new customers who received a thank you letter after each payment compared to a control group that did not receive any reinforcement.

5.9 SUMMARY

Learning is a relatively permanent change in behaviour that is caused by experience. Learning can occur through simple associations between a stimulus and a response, or via a complex series of cognitive activities. Behavioural learning theories assume that learning occurs as a result of responses to external events. Classical conditioning occurs when a stimulus that naturally elicits a response (an unconditioned stimulus) is paired with another stimulus that does not initially elicit this response. Over time, the second stimulus (the conditioned stimulus) comes to elicit the response as well. Operant or instrumental conditioning occurs as the person learns to perform behaviours that produce positive outcomes and avoid those that result in negative outcomes. While classical conditioning involves the pairing of two stimuli, instrumental learning occurs when reinforcement is delivered following a response to a stimulus. Cognitive learning occurs as the result of mental processes. Observational learning takes place when the consumer performs behaviour as a result of seeing someone else performing it and being rewarded for it. Memory refers to the storage of learned information. The way information is encoded when it is perceived determines how it will be stored in memory. The memory systems comprising of sensory memory, short-term memory, and long-term memory each play a role in retaining and processing information from the outside world.

5.10 KEY WORDS

Classical conditioning	:	The learning that occurs when stimulus eliciting a response is paired with another stimulus that initially does not elicit a response on its own, but will cause a response over time since it is associated with the first stimulus.
Cognitive learning	:	The learning that occurs as a result of internal mental processes.
Extinction	:	The process whereby a learned connection between a stimulus and response is eroded.
Long-term memory	:	The system that allows us to retain information for a longer time.
Operant conditioning	:	The process by which consumer learn to use the behaviour that produces positive outcomes.

5.11 SELF-ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

- 1) Define learning from the marketing point of view? What are the essential features of classical learning approach?
- 2) Distinguish between the instrumental learning and the classical learning approaches. Which of the two is more complete and why? Under what marketing situations would you seek to apply each and why?

- 3) Would you call the cognitive theory of learning as the information processing approach for human learning? Why, in spite of its merit, the theory loses out to the other theories in advertising world?
- 4) What factors are the most important in terms of retrieving information? How would you as a marketer apply your knowledge of such factors?
- 5) Should marketers work at the addressing short-term memory or the long-term memory? How are the two are related?
- 6) How do different types of reinforcement enhance learning? How does the strategy of frequency marketing relate to conditioning?
- 7) Describe in learning terms the conditions under which family branding is a good policy and those under which it is not.

5.12 PROJECT QUESTIONS

1. Create an ad copy on any hypothetical product. Show the copy to a group of five friends thrice in a week. While to another group of friends, show the copy thrice in one day. After the week is over, ask them about the copy you had shown. Report what is the difference in terms of recalling the information from the advertisement.
2. Recall jingles and tunes used by brands in commercials? Is there something specific that triggers recall? Are they original jingles or tunes or are they "borrowed"?

5.13 FURTHER READINGS

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UNIT 6 ATTITUDE AND ATTITUDE CHANGE

Learning outcomes

After going through this unit, you should be able to:

- explain the conceptualization and formation of consumer attitude
- describe the linkage among the Consumer Beliefs, Attitude and purchase intentions
- identify the problems and the value of measuring Attitude and their managerial implications
- apply the knowledge of Attitude and attitude change in your marketing decisions
- distinguish between the various models of attitudes and their application

Structure

- 6.1 Introduction
- 6.2 Attitude and Consumer Decision-Making
- 6.3 The Constituents of Consumer Attitude
- 6.4 The Functions of Consumer Attitude
- 6.5 Consumer Attitude: The Models
- 6.6 The Marketing Response to the Consumer Attitude
- 6.7 Summary
- 6.8 Key Words
- 6.9 Self-Assessment Questions
- 6.10 Project Questions
- 6.11 Further Readings

Internet and technology innovations have transformed many business models. E-commerce is one of such innovations that have revolutionised the business operations and facilitated the online marketing. Technology adoption and change in lifestyle of consumers have paved the way for online shopping. Certainly, the Covid 19 pandemic and the lockdown that disabled physical and face to face economic activity, accelerated the adoption of online buying across the world and India was no exception. The interesting thing to note however, is that once the lockdown restrictions eased away, a large percentage of consumers report an irreversible change in their buying habits as during this gap of over one year, a large number of them got used to the convenience of shopping from the convenience of their homes or offices on an anytime anyone basis. The vastly improved online shopping platforms, stable and reliable payment options, and improve logistic efficiencies have further added to the consumer convenience and improved experience.

What does it involve by way of attitude and attitude change?

6.1 INTRODUCTION

To a lay person, consumer attitude should represent as the summary statement of his assessment about anything. Thus, a consumer may have a negative attitude for the products made in Korea. What it means is, that the consumer has assessed the products of the country and found them to be of not very high quality. This is what a consumer attitude represents.

Theoretically speaking, attitude is “learned predisposition to respond in a consistently favourable and unfavourable manner with respect to a given stimuli”

Another way of describing attitude is that it is a “relatively enduring organization of inter-related beliefs that describe, evaluate, and advocate action with respect to an object or a situation.”

Several characteristics of attitude are evident from these two descriptions. The first is that attitude is ‘not a transient feeling’ but represents an enduring feeling or enduring evaluation. Secondly, it derives its genesis and strength from a variety of sources of information including perception and experience. Thirdly, it signals about the likely course of action by the consumer and fourth that an attitude is the product of learning and is not something inherited or inborn

Attitude is also used as a replacement term for describing ‘belief system’ of a person.

Activity 1

Define attitude in your own words. What characteristics appear to be most important while dealing with the attitude towards say, Smartphones in India.

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6.2 ATTITUDE AND CONSUMER DECISION MAKING

In everyday life, consumers receive a variety of marketing communications about what they should buy and they should not. They come to know about different claims and standing of the brands. On the basis of inputs received from various sources, consumers develop their assessment of the brands, better known as the brand-image. The brand image helps consumers in believing which brand is more likely to have a particular benefit or a feature (technically known as the product attribute). It should be noted here that since these brand beliefs are based on consumer perception, they may sometimes be at variance with reality. Thus, a potential car buyer may believe that the brand **A** of car has style but it may not be actually true about the brand **A**. In a similar vein, a potential lipstick buyer may believe that the brand **B** of the lipstick has the attribute of social prestige. In reality, it may not be so. Thus, consumer attitudes are based on the what they know or believe about a given object whether this knowledge is true or otherwise. But they provide a very important clue as to whether the consumers will take a particular course of action or not.

Thus, a person after having been bombarded by a string of digital media ads on various Smart TV brands available in India, may suddenly observe: “Oh, the TV ads! I can’t stand them anymore!”

Similarly, a typical housewife may have this to say to her husband, after having viewed the Sunday morning transmission: “You know something, the TV ads are so fascinating that they have taught a lot to our children in making brand choices for grocery”.

These two statements express a summary evaluation of a marketing stimulus i.e., promotional methods, and indicate how these will play out in case of consumers who were asked to respond. Thus, the first consumer will probably zap the TV commercials or skip them. The housewife may regulate the viewing hours of the television for the children.

Activity 2

In view of the above discussion explain the following consumer behaviour:

- a) Some consumers shop in a wide variety of stores while others restrict themselves to a few known stores.

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- b) Some products are purchased after extensive searching. Others are bought at a moment’s notice.

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- c) Two people are exposed to the same ad - one notices and processes the ad; and forms a favourable impression of the product while the other is unaware of its existence.

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6.3 THE CONSTITUENTS OF CONSUMER ATTITUDE

In the subsequent block 3, we will deal with the major variables that a buyer would face during information search for the purpose of evaluating and reaching a choice. One of the variables that would guide the customer in the process, is the consumer attitude. Since an attitude provides a series of cues to marketers with reference to evaluation procedure, an understanding of consumer attitude can help marketers predict future purchases; and gauge the strength or otherwise of their its present sales. Even they redesign their marketing mix efforts.

Attitude, as a concept, however, is far from simple. An attitude consists of three constituents. These are affective; cognitive and conative. Affective part of the attitude refers to the feelings that a consumer has about a given object. The cognitive part refers to the information and knowledge basis of these consumers about that object. The third and final part of the attitude - the conative, refers to the intention of the customer in relation to the object.

A schematic conception of attitudes is attempted in Figure 6.1.

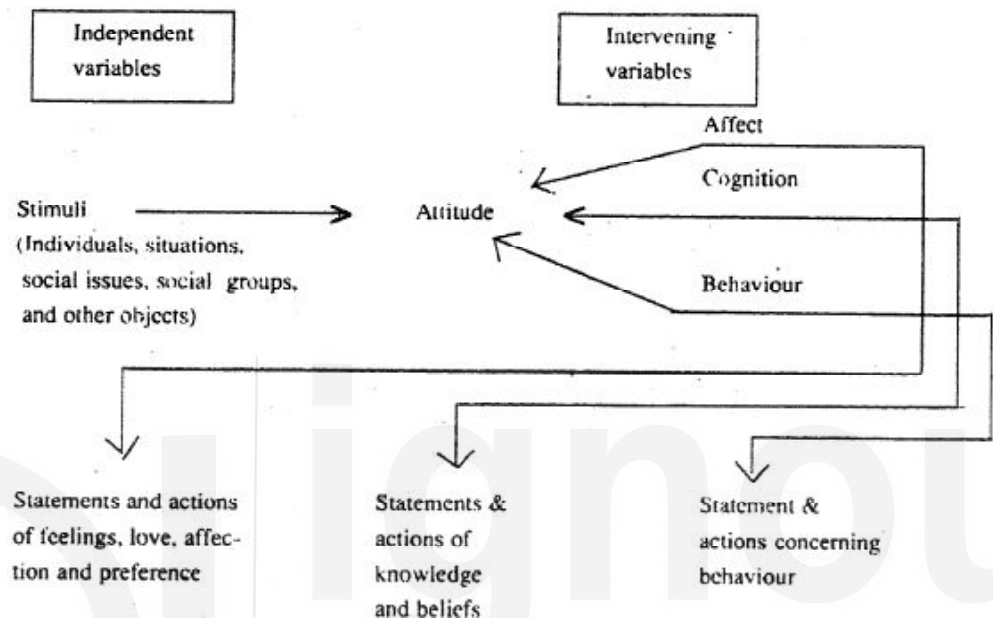


Figure 6.1 : Schematic Conception of Attitudes

The Figure 6.1 can be amplified by a hypothetical example of the attitude formation in respect of an individual as well as an institutional buyer. For instance, assume that a research study reveals that Indian females have a favourable attitude towards Samsung brand of Smartphones. Similarly, assume that TATA Steel too has indicated its favourable attitude towards HCL desktop computers. In operational terms, these findings summarize the knowledge of these buyers as to what Samsung Smartphone and HCL desktop computers may possess. Secondly, they indicate how the female buyers and the TATA Steel feel about these brands. Thirdly, they indicate the likely action if these buyers are asked to go for these respective products, i.e., Samsung Smartphone and HCL desktop computers.

To sum up, attitude indicates knowledge, feelings and likely action for the given stimulus.

Activity 3

Elaborate the following statements in terms of the constituents of attitudes you just studied.

a) "I hate fast food"

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b) "I love fuel efficient cars"

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6.4 THE FUNCTIONS OF CONSUMER ATTITUDE

Notwithstanding the importance of consumer attitude, two serious criticisms have been levelled against it. The foremost criticism is that it makes a rather naive assumption that attitudes influence the specific and overt behaviour of consumer. The real facts don't support it so clearly. Yet, the functions of attitude are too important to be left un-described. Consumer attitudes in their most rudimentary form, render the following function as explained in figure 6.2.

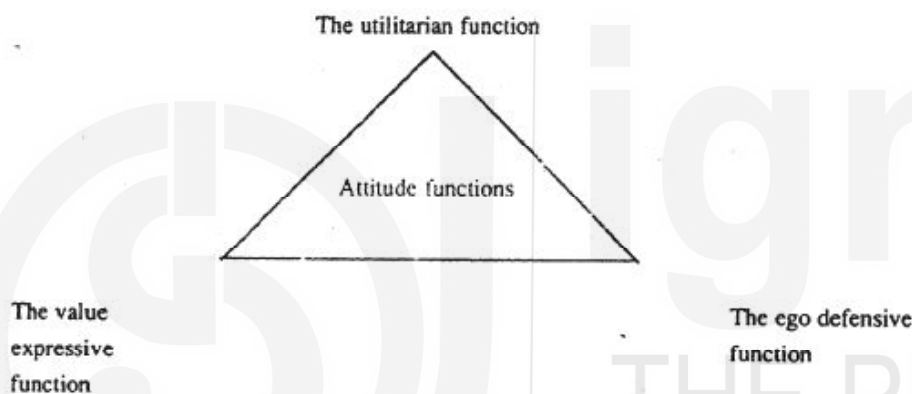


Figure 6.2 : Functions of Attitude

6.4.1 The Utilitarian Function

Consumer attitudes fulfil a utilitarian function as they guide consumers in achieving their desired needs. Thus, if the Smart TV buyers consider technology and after-sales service support as the two most important criteria in Smart TV selection, the buyers will be most attracted by the messages of those brand alternatives that claim to possess the two attributes. Such attitudes towards these brands will help the consumer achieve what he wants. Also, it will assist them in avoiding failure and disappointment in brand evaluation.

6.4.2 The Ego Defensive Function

This function protects consumers against internal and external anxieties and environment. Herein, the marketing stimuli and more particularly, product characteristics become an instrument of the protection process. Many consumer psychologists have led marketers to believe that a positive consumer attitude towards expensive jeweller wrist watches and other visible prestige products serve as mechanism of ego defence for these consumers. It should be cautioned here, however, that expensive items alone do not constitute a mechanism of defence for consumers. The low-priced products like mouthwash, deodorants too can serve the same protection function from anxiety etc. as they secure the consumer against the consequences of embarrassing oral or body odour.

6.4.3 The Value-Expressive Function

Often consumer use their attitudes as an expression of their values and self-concept. Value expressive function of attitudes enables consumers to maintain self-identity and leads them to value expression and determination. The projection is often strong, evident and extreme because consumers openly express opinions that reflect their strong beliefs and self- concept. The application of this function is all too evident in consumer selection and evaluation of products, their price, promotional items and the distribution outlets, their spend save decisions and activities like home decor. Thus, a consumer, in order to express his simple and Gandhian values in life, will always prefer and wear handloom and Khadi, support products of the small-scale industries and may have a negative attitude against conspicuous consumption and their public endorsement by the commercial houses. Normally, there is a tendency on the part of consumers to flaunt this kind of attitude through their consumption.

Activity 4

- a) Evaluate the attitude of your friends regarding the use of the vacuum cleaners. Categorize them in terms of the functions of attitudes just described.

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- b) Suggest at least three ways in which the marketers can modify these attitudes.

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6.5 CONSUMER ATTITUDE MODELS

Model-making in attitudes have been attempted in a variety of ways. Most prominent among them are the different multi-attribute attitude models. Given below is an account of the same.

6.5.1 Multi-attribute Attitude Models

Multi-attribute attitude models explain how consumers may combine their beliefs about product attributes to form their attitudes about various brand alternatives. These models assume that the brand which receives the best attitude, will be chosen. They further assume that consumers will go through the standard Hierarchy of Effects sequence (i.e., Awareness - Interest - Desire - Action).

A careful scrutiny of all multi-attribute attitude models establishes two general categories of these models. Category I comprises the models that emphasize the Attitude- Toward — Objects. Hence, they are termed as ATO models. Category II consists of those models that focus on predicting the behavioural intentions (BI) of consumers to perform certain action. This action could be purchase or non-purchase. For brevity's sake, it is termed as BI Model. Figure 6.3 illustrates the point.

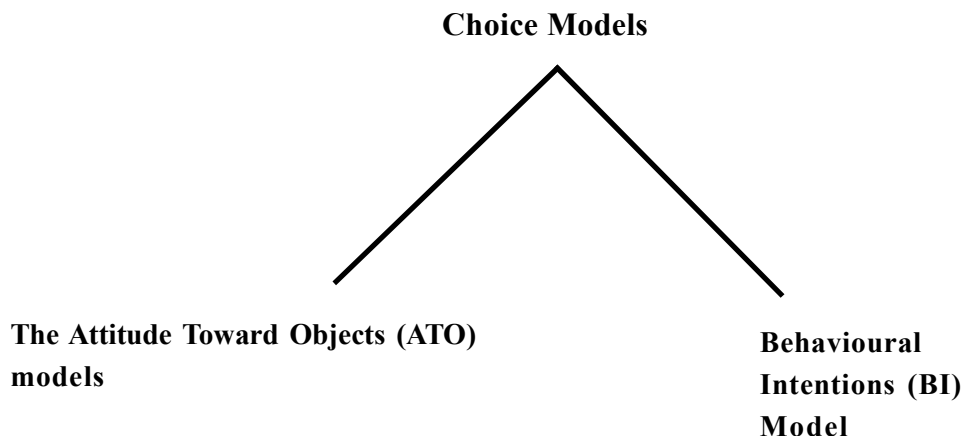


Figure 6.3 : Multi-attributes of Choice Models

A) The Attitude-Toward-Objects (ATO) Models

Although a variety of ATO models are found in consumer research; most of these models seek information on the importance of brand attributes; beliefs about the presence or absence of those attributes in the brand alternatives and information on their combined effect in alternative evaluation. Fishbein's model (1972) represents this genre of models. Algebraically, the model is expressed as:

$$A_0 = \sum_{i=1}^n B_i a_i, \text{ where}$$

A_0 = the overall attitude toward object 'O'
 B_i = the belief of whether or not object 'O' has a particular attribute
 a_i = the importance rating of the attributes
 n = the number of beliefs

Table 6.1 explains a hypothetical multi-attitude evaluation of three brands of family cars in India.

Table 6.1 Multi-attribute Evaluation

Attribute (1)	Weight (2)	Brand A (3)		Brand B (4)		Brand C (5)	
		3.1	3.2	4.1	4.2	5.1	5.2
	a	B	aXB	B	aXB	B	aXB
Design	3	3	9	2	6	5	15
Low Maintenance Cost	2	3	6	2	4	2	4
Fuel Efficiency	1	3	3	3	3	5	5
			18		13		24

Column 2 states the hypothetical ratings of importance of three attributes. The three rows show the attributes that are important criteria of evaluation. The consumers' belief on these attributes is shared under each brand column. The product of the weightage and the beliefs (b) have been rated in columns 3.2, 4.2 and 5.2. The minimum 1 and maximum 5 indicate the unlikelihood or likelihood of that attributes to be possessed by the given brand alternatives of the cars, respectively.

A further examination the table will reveal that Brand **A** has been rated as an average car. In contrast Brand **C** is rated higher on attributes like low maintenance cost and styling. Finally, Brand **B** car emerges as the worst car of the lot. Following this, a consumer will have formed the most positive attitude toward Brand **C**.

Activity 5

Visit a leading refrigerator shop of your town and interview one or two buyers about their attitude towards these major brands of 165 litre refrigerator. Use an ATO model for analyzing their information.

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Criticisms: The ATO models, however, suffer from a major weakness. They fail to consider that quite often, consumer attitude does not fully equate with behaviour. Thus, a potential car buyer in spite of having the most positive attitude towards ‘Maruti’, may never engage in the behaviour of buying it. This could be because of the adverse opinion of other important people or due to temptation of investing the funds more profitably elsewhere. Situational influences may prevent him from engaging in the act of buying. The Behaviour Intentions (BI) model attempts to rectify this weakness of the ATO.

Activity 6

Prepare a similar table for the Smart televisions, using three brands as the alternative and four attributes as the criteria. You can choose the weights as per your own understanding of the attributes affecting evaluation of this product.

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B) The Behaviour Intentions (BI) Model

The BI model is in effect, an extension of Fishbein’s ATO model. The model does not attempt to predict behaviour per se but intentions to behave algebraically, the model is as follows:

$$B=BI = W_1 (A_B) + W_2 (SN)$$

Where

B = behaviour; BI = Behaviour Intention

A_B = attitude toward performing the behaviour, SN = the subjective norm

W_1 and W_2 , are empirically determined weights, through regression analysis.

A_B and SN are obtained directly from consumers via questionnaires. Thus, A_B is obtained from the following equation:

$$A_B = \sum_{i=1}^n b_i e_i$$

A_B = attitude toward the behaviour

b_i = the person's belief that performing the behaviour will result in consequence

e_i = the person's evaluation of consequence

n = the number of beliefs

The above equation has one major difference over the earlier Fishbein's ATO Model. It is that the BI Model assesses the person's belief that performing a particular behaviour will result in a particular consequence. This model therefore moves forward from the belief regarding an attribute of an object to the intention of behaving towards that object. They are termed as Subjective Norms (SN). The equation for obtaining the subjective norms is as follows:

$$SN = \sum_{j=1}^n NB_j MC_j$$

Where,

SN = subjective norm;

NB_j = the normative belief that a reference group of persons j thinks that the consumer should or should not perform the behaviour;

MC_j = the motivation to comply with the influence of the referent j and

n = number of relevant reference groups of individuals.

This model therefore moves forward from the belief regarding an attribute of an object to the intention of behaving towards that object. Various research studies have found the BI model to be superior to the standard multi-attribute choice models, though eye-brows have been raised concerning the calculation of the subjective norms (SN). In practice, this exercise is never so simple.

Activity 7

Illustrate the above model of attitude by taking hypothetical values of the model in buying Microwave oven. What difficulties do you encounter?

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6.6 THE MARKETING RESPONSE TO THE CONSUMER ATTITUDE

After having made an analysis of attitude and its formation, and the models, the questions that arise for marketers to consider are as follows: what are their

marketing implications of understanding attitudes and what actions are useful in managing them?

A very significant implication arises from that attitudes are learned predispositions and marketers understand that one of the major components of all attitudes is the cognitive component formed on the basis of what the consumer 'knows' about the object. Marketers therefore can appreciate that by changing the consumer learning about the given object, attitudes can be changed. This is a very powerful proposition and can create opportunities for marketers to contribute to the development of attitudes for their new products and modify existing negative attitudes over a period of time by correcting misinformation and developing credible new beliefs through learning. Table 6.2 outlines the areas in which such inferences and actions can be contemplated.

Table 6.2: Areas of Marketing Inferences and Actions

Area	Inference (s)	Action (s)
Market-Identification	* Segment market on the bases of Product-Attribute beliefs; Attribute Benefit beliefs; and Product-Benefit beliefs.	* Market Product on the basis of lifestyle and Benefit Segmentale
Competitive Analysis	* Possibility of attribute, beliefs and benefits manipulation * Positioning of Product	* Change own product attributes and those of competitors * Continuously review product positioning with proper communication support
Marketing Mix	* Sources of ideas for new products * Communication has impact on consumer learning * Importance of Price-evaluation matrix * Distribution outlets add to product image	* Use consumer perceptions and attitudes to design new products * Enrich Consumers with fresh and distinct information * Price-perception should be made in line with brand image * Encourage distribution in consumer evaluation
Marketing opportunity analysis	* Need of a constant eye on Demographics and social changes	* Create exclusive riches or segments of consumer demographics
Attitude formation & measurement	* Attitude is an indicator of brand preference and behaviour * Continuous feel of the market essential	* Strengthen the positive attitude and modify the unsuitable ones by a variety of means * Develop a regular attitude-checking system

Specifically, marketers may choose one or a combination of steps to move consumers' evaluation of brand alternatives in their favour. Marketers may, for the beginning, modify their brand alternation in case they find the consumers ratings to be true and genuine. Further, marketers may attempt to modify consumer ratings to be true and genuine. Also, marketers may attempt to modify consumer beliefs about the brand alternative through sharper communication along with other marketing efforts. However, in case of competitive evaluation, marketer also attempt to alter consumer beliefs about competitive brand alternatives vis-à-vis about theirs. It is done either by running down the high-importance product attributes, on which competitive products

are better rated; or by deprecating their performance. A more positive route, open to marketers, however, is by creating fresh brand attributes or by giving a new focus on the neglected brand attributes. The same could be done even by manipulating the ideal-product to bring it closer to the marketers' own brand alternative.

To sum up, marketers have an unenviable task on their hands while consumers are at the stage of brand evaluation. The acid test of marketing effectiveness in this regard is whether consumers are led to the actual purchase action or not. The answer in either way will pronounce judgment on the adequacy of marketing response.

Activity 8

Identify one example of each of the suggestions described above for influencing consumer attitude. Also state how far have the marketers succeeded in their attempts?

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6.7 SUMMARY

The unit began by picking up the threads of continuity from Unit 4 whereby consumer perceptions were described and by building upon the concept of learning as we describe attitudes in terms of learned predispositions. Consumer attitudes perform a vital function in consumer choice as they affect consumer evaluation of alternatives. The unit goes on to describe the various functions and components of attitudes. The various models of attitudes have been discussed it enable you to get a clear understanding of how attitudes are formed and how do they function in the consumer decision-making process.

Based on all these inputs, the unit then discusses the implications of using the knowledge of consumer attitudes in marketing decision making.

6.8 KEY WORDS

- Product-Attribute Association** : The relationship between the brands held in consumers' memory and the qualities or attributes of a product.
- Belief** : The cognitive knowledge people have of the relation among attributes, benefits and objects.
- Attribute-Object Belief** : The consumer's evaluation of the extent to which a particular, object possesses a particular attribute.
- Attribute-Benefit Belief** : The consumer's evaluation of the extent to which a particular attribute will result in a particular benefit.

Object-Benefit Belief	: A belief that a product has certain attributes.
Hierarchy of Effect	: Various models that explain the order in which beliefs, feelings and behaviour affect consumers.
Multi-attribute Models	: The Models that identify how consumers combine their beliefs about product attributes and make choices among various brand alternatives.

6.9 SELF-ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

1. What is meant by consumer attitude? How do you justify the relevance of studying attitudes when they may not accurately predict action? Give an example to illustrate your answer.
2. Identify the kinds of information that a consumer may collect to form his or her attitude. How can it help his brand evaluation later?
3. What is meant by multi-attribute attitude models? How do they get applied in practice?
4. ABC company-a manufacturer of a simple, low priced and easy to handle Mobile handset, wishes to market it in rural areas. What will you suggest by way of modification of rural consumers' attitude toward Mobile handsets and their brand evaluation?
5. We sometimes enhance our attitude toward a product after we buy it. How does the theory of cognitive dissonance explain this change?

6.10 PROJECT QUESTIONS

1. Devise an attitude questionnaire to find out the consumer attitude toward any of the following: (a) Mutual funds, (b) Designer home furniture, (c) Health foods, (d) Electric cars
2. List as many attributes as you can in a Laptop computer for an executive that you would like to see in a laptop.
3. Construct a multi-attribute model for a set of local restaurants in your city. Based on your findings, suggest how restaurant owners could improve their establishment's image via the strategies described in this chapter.

6.11 FURTHER READINGS

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UNIT 7 PERSONALITY AND SELF-CONCEPT

Learning Outcomes

After going through this unit, you should be able to:

- explain how personality and self-concept affect consumer behaviour
- describe the various theories of personality and distinguish between them
- explain the various terms associated with self-concept
- explain how marketers respond to the significance of the personality and self-concept
- discuss the marketing applications of both personality and self-concept.

Structure

- 7.1 Introduction
- 7.2 An overview of Personality: Its Nature & Their Application to Consumer Behaviour
- 7.3 The Concept of Personality
- 7.4 Theories of Personality
- 7.5 The Psychoanalytic Theory of Freud
- 7.6 Social-Psychological or Neo-Freudian Theory
- 7.7 Trait Theory of Personality
- 7.8 The Theory of Self-concept
- 7.9 The Related Concepts
- 7.10 Consumption and Self-concept
- 7.11 Summary
- 7.12 Key Words
- 7.13 Self-Assessment Questions
- 7.14 Project Questions
- 7.15 Further Readings

Smart phones have revolutionized the mode of communication and became our irreplaceable technology partner. It is all in one tool that has integrated many devices and applications such as digital camera, music and video players, a calendar, a calculator, a game console, online banking and transactions etc. The Indian smartphone market revenue crossed \$38 billion in 2021, registering a growth of 27 per cent YoY. The major brands with significant market share include Xiaomi, Samsung, Realme, Apple, Vivo, Oppo, OnePlus, and others. However, establishing a brand personality is not just about putting sales-driven content, it's about innovating and educating your audience as well as exhibiting your personality to stand out in the minds of your customers. Brands, like people, develop real-life personas over time. For example, the Apple brand personality is about lifestyle, imagination,

7.1 INTRODUCTION

Take a good look around yourself, at the market, and at your own purchases of the products and services there from. Chances are good that you will notice something important - an invisible connection between these important symbols of our consumption system. Either these products are projecting a personality and an image that has an appeal to their customers or they are remodelling their personality and image to suit those images that their target customers have. Thus, Brand Tata promises trust and dependability, and Titan stands for lifestyle.

Why such a trend is developing? The subsequent sections will attempt to answer why.

7.2 AN OVERVIEW OF PERSONALITY: ITS NATURE AND THEIR APPLICATION TO CONSUMER BEHAVIOUR

All of us, at some time or another, have described friends or acquaintances in terms of their personalities. We may have described someone as having a 'friendly personality', someone else as having an 'aggressive personality'. Sometimes we go to the extent of saying that someone has a 'personality problem'. The term personality is used, in other words, to describe individuals in terms of their exhibited traits.

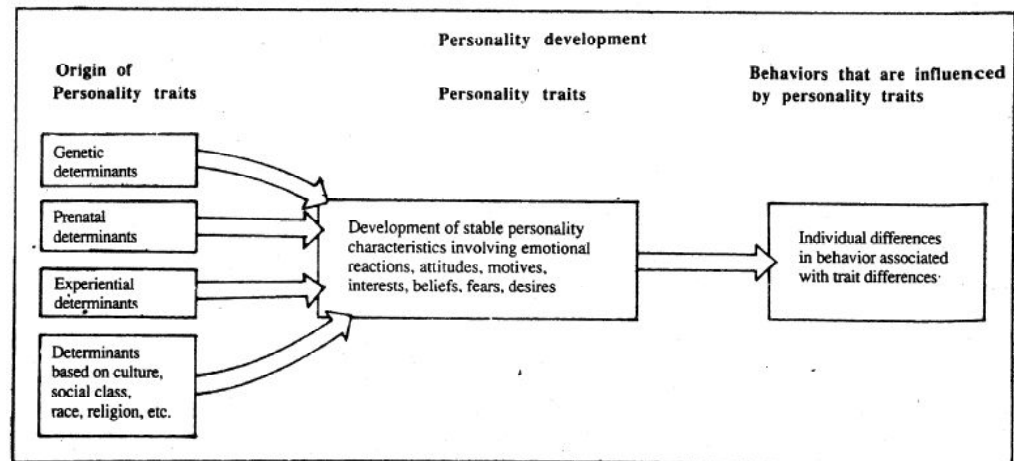
When we talk of personality, however, we do not just mean that a person is charming, has a positive attitude towards life, or a smiling face. Personality is a much more dynamic concept which describes the growth and development of an individual's whole psychological system. The fundamental question of concern to marketers has been that, given that consumers differ on readily identifiable characteristics such as personality, how do these factors influence their consumption behaviour and how do marketers utilise their understanding of such individualistic variables?

As you know the personality is the composite sum total of an individual's psychological traits, characteristics, motives, habits, attitudes, beliefs and outlooks. Over the years many different definitions have been proposed. One of the most widely used is that by Allport according to which personality is defined as an 'internal system' which includes all those aspects of a person that are inherited as well as those that are learned. These two internal aspects are interdependent and cannot be isolated'. You will see this illustrated in Figure 7.1 which highlights the origin of personality traits.

Some theorists believe that personality differences can be explained primarily, if not completely, by how individuals acquire their behaviour patterns. If, as stated, personality is the result of a complex interaction of genetic and environmental inputs then every person is, in certain respects:

1. like all other persons
2. like some other persons
3. like no other persons

Figure 7.1 Origin of Personality Traits



In other words, each person has some attributes in common with all other human beings and other, totally unique qualities. Thus, we share certain characteristics with others because of our biological make-up. For instance, you will find that some personality characteristics are dictated by heredity. Thus, you may be ‘relaxed and easy going’ because your parents were similarly so. A second important factor that impinges on our personality formation is the culture in which we were raised, and our early conditioning, along with the groups and institutions from which that culture is acquired. Thus, our families and peers, i.e., friends and associates; are important reference groups that influence our own personality characteristics.

Furthermore, it is necessary for you to note that, since learning contributes to personality formation, the personality is not fixed because, learning itself is a continuous process and may differ between individuals and for the same individual at different stages of his life. This does not mean, however, that personality is unstable or is subject to abrupt changes. On the contrary, basic personality change is exceedingly difficult and, also, slow to occur.

For your purpose you should think of personality as the sum total of ways in which an individual reacts and interacts.

As a concept applied to marketing, personality can be viewed as having following distinct characteristics:

- 1) Personality is used to account for differences between individuals rather than show how people are alike. Here again, refer to Figure 7.1. This enables us to categorize people into groups on the basis of a single or a few traits. The difficulty inherent in trying to understand uniqueness has led to an emphasis on such measurable characteristics as intelligence, aggressiveness, and sociability. Unique combinations of individual characteristics result in variations in thought and behaviour and these tend to differentiate one person from another.
- 2) Personality is a set of response tendencies that are consistent and endure over time. Consistency means that the characteristics contributing to an individual’s personality tend to carry over to a variety of situations. Consistency is essential if marketers are to predict consumer behaviour in terms of personalities. The stable nature of the underlying personality characteristics also suggests that it is unreasonable for marketing practitioners to attempt to change consumers personalities. At best they can attempt to appeal to the relevant personality traits inherent in target groups of consumers.

- 3) Personality is, however, subject to change over time, in response to situations and events in life and, also, as part of a gradual maturing process.
- 4) Finally, it is not possible to predict an individual's purchase behaviour from single measures of personality, we cannot expect to predict the type of furniture a person will own, merely by looking at specific personality characteristics.

Activity 1

- 1) Make a list below, of six of your personality characteristics that you would say are inherited from your parents.
- 2) Next, list six personality characteristics where you are like some of your friends.
- 3) Finally, list down six personality characteristics of yours which no person around you appears to possess.

Personality Characteristics		
Similar to Parents	Similar to Friends	Like no other Person
i) _____	_____	_____
ii) _____	_____	_____
iii) _____	_____	_____
iv) _____	_____	_____
v) _____	_____	_____
vi) _____	_____	_____

7.3 THE CONCEPT OF PERSONALITY

We all have in our mind different interpretations of the term personality. The concept in behavioural sciences however is quite clear and well explained. But first a few definitions. Let us begin with the one on the personality. Personality refers to 'a person's unique psychological makeup and how it consistently influences the way a person responds to his or her environment'.

In recent years, the nature of the personality construct has been hotly debated. Many studies have found that people tend not to behave consistently across different situations and that, they do not seem to exhibit stable personalities. In fact, some researchers feel that personality does not really exist at all. According to them, it is merely a convenient way to describe the behaviour of other people.

This argument is a bit hard to accept intuitively, possibly because we tend to see others in a limited range of situations, and so to us, people do act consistently. On the other hand, we each know that we are not all that consistent, we may be wild and crazy at times and the model of respectability at others. While certainly not all psychologists have abandoned the idea of personality, many now recognize that a person's underlying characteristics are but one part of the puzzle and that situational factors behaviour. This realization underscores the potential importance of segmenting

according to situations. Be that as it may, there are several theories that have been advanced to explain the concept of personality.

Activity 2

Do you agree that concept of personality is real, at least in the context of marketing? Illustrate your answer.

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7.4 THEORIES OF PERSONALITY

There are several theories that have been proposed on personality. While there is no agreement on exactly how personality influences behaviour, there are at least four distinct approaches that are known to have implications for developing the marketing mix and for segmentation.

Each of these theories has played a prominent role in studying the relationship between consumer personalities and their behaviour. These theories are:

- 1) The Psychoanalytic Theory of Freud
- 2) Social-Psychological Neo-Freudian Theory
- 3) Trait Theory
- 4) Self-Concept Theory

7.5 THE PSYCHOANALYTIC THEORY OF FREUD

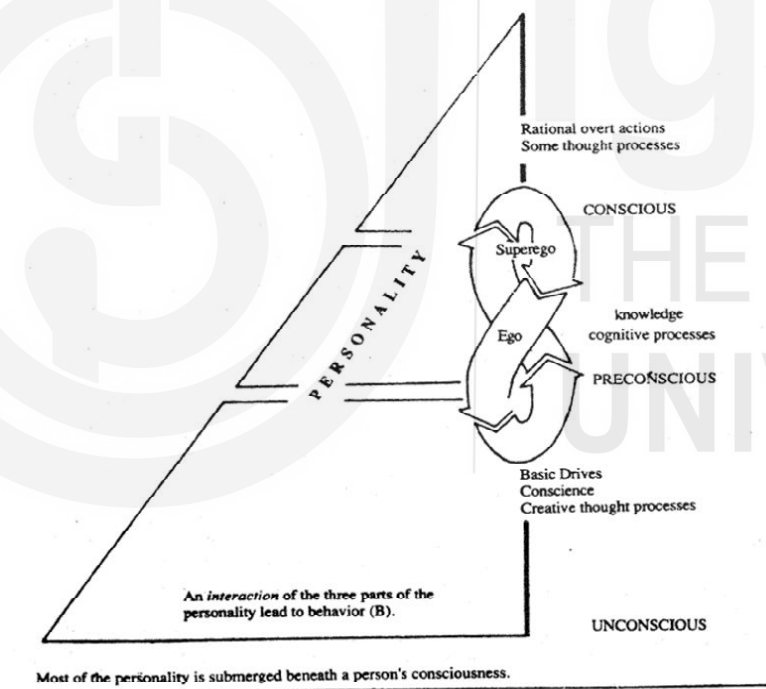
Freud proposed that every individual's personality is the product of a struggle among three interacting forces: the id, the ego and the superego. Have a look at Figure 7.2. According to this theory, these three systems are fully developed and are in a state of balance in a normal healthy person. However, when one or more of these systems is underdeveloped then the internal balance is disturbed. This disturbance leads to maladjustment and dissatisfaction with the self and the world in general.

According to Freud, the id is the source of strong, inborn, basic, instinctive drives and urges which are at the heart of a consumer's motivation and personality. The function of the id is discharge tension and it frequently does this by demanding instant gratification, even at the cost of violating the norms of society. The id therefore operates on what is called the **pleasure principle**. Psychologically, the id is the source of all desires and wishes that exist in the form of unconscious images and fantasies. Since all tensions are not immediately satisfied, the human being encounters frustration. For example, when an individual is hot and thirsty, the id will urge him or her to grab something cold to drink

Since it operates on a very subjective level, the id is not capable of dealing with objective reality. The ego comes into being because of the limitations of the id in dealing with reality and operates, therefore, on what is called the **reality principle**. It seeks to achieve the pleasurable demands of the id in as realistic a way as possible. Since many of the id's demands may be unrealistic, the ego develops ways to postpone, deflect or substitute feasible alternatives to satisfy the id. To take a simple example, let us assume that an individual sees an attractive object in a shop window and wants it immediately. The ego recognises the consequences such as the financial constraints, a need for the product, and accordingly restrains activity. It thus helps to develop cognition and controls impulsive behaviour. Thus, while the id engages in daydreams and fantasy, which exist as pleasurable imaginations, the ego can distinguish between these and reality.

The superego strives for perfection. It develops through the reinforcement of approved behaviour patterns and results from the internalisation of societal and parental standards of what is good and bad. The superego is, therefore, the individual's moral code and helps in striving for perfection. Its primary purpose is, accordingly, to restrain aggressive impulses of the id rather than seek to postpone them, as does the ego.

Figure 7.2 Freud's View of the Personality



It is believed that the id and superego operate to create to unconscious motives for purchasing certain products. Although these motives would be extremely hard to determine, they might be central to explaining certain purchasing behaviours. Now try the following.

Activity 3

List down four products that you presently possess (consumer durables or non-durables), that you felt anxious about, before the purchase was made. Explain the reason for the anxiety. Also explain the reason by which you justified the purchase.

	Products you possess	Reason for anxiety before purchasing	Reason by which you justified the buy (function of the ego)
i)			
ii)			
iii)			
iv)			

Applications of Psychoanalytic Theory.

Psychoanalytic theory has been used occasionally by marketers as a basis for influencing consumers. According to psychoanalytic theory, consumers are seen as having conflicting desires as they are confronted with products to gratify wants. And according to Freudian theory, anxiety is a key concept emerging out of this conflict system. One application, therefore, is for consumers to minimise the anxiety arising out of this conflict system by appealing to their tendencies of fantasizing, wish fulfilment, aggressive impulses and the need to escape from life's pressures.

Marketers therefore use flights of fantasy to propel people to **buy products**. Thus, hedonism is an appeal to the pleasure principle and, this approach underlies many of the products designed for an affluent society.

Psychoanalytic theory has, however, caused marketers to realise that, while it is possible to appeal subconsciously to buyers' dreams, hopes and fears, there are other occasions when it is necessary to provide buyers with socially acceptable rational for making purchases.

7.6 SOCIAL-PSYCHOLOGICAL OR NEO-FREUDIAN THEORY

Some social-psychologists have forwarded the view that, social relationships are fundamental to the formations and development of personality. On the basis of their orientations in relating to others, individual consumers tend to develop methods to cope with their anxieties. Consumers have consequently been classified into three personality groups using what is called the '**CAD model**' where CAD is an acronym that stands for compliance, aggression and detachment. The CAD model was developed by using the concept of 'interpersonal man' and considers all consumers as having one of three basic orientations so that they may be described as belonging to one of the following categories of individuals:

- i) **Compliant Individuals:** These individuals tend to move toward others. Compliant people have a need for love, affection, approval and the desire to be appreciated. They are essentially conformists.
- ii) **Aggressive Individuals:** They tend to move against others. Their interpersonal orientations display the ability to manipulate others. Such individuals also appear to have a need to achieve success, to excel, to gain admiration and to be in a power position.

- iii) **Detached Individuals:** This category of persons tends to move away from others. Their relationships emphasize the need for self-reliance, independence, and freedom.

Application of Social-psychological Theory

It has been found that individuals having different personality types tend to use different products and brands. The CAD model was, in fact, developed for the specific purpose of studying buying behaviour and it emphasises the effect of social influences on the personality. Thus, studies have shown that compliant types have been found to prefer known products and brands while aggressive types have been found to prefer specific brands out of a desire to be noticed, and also to use more of aftershave lotions and colognes. In contrast, detached types appear to have the least awareness of brands.

The CAD approach is used by marketers to predict which consumers may be more or less prone to group influence.

The most important application of social-psychological theory is its emphasis on the social nature of consumption. In fact, you will see this in advertising copy in which social interaction is stressed more than the products themselves. The entire series of Cadbury chocolate ads with the byline ‘Kuch Meetha ho jaye’ display a variety of social relationship situations being strengthened through this consumption. Advertising for personal care products, for instance, emphasises the fear of offending others. Social interaction is also highlighted in the case of products advertised for occasions for being together.

Activity 4

Mention the three key words of psychoanalytic and the social theories of personality and compare them together.

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7.7 TRAIT THEORY OF PERSONALITY

Trait theory of personality is one of the recent and slightly implementable theory of personality. The approach here is to focus on the quantitative measurement of traits, or identifiable characteristics that define a person. For example, people can be distinguished by the degree to which they are socially outgoing (the trait of extroversion). Some specific traits that are relevant to consumer behaviour include innovativeness (the degree to which a person likes to try new things), materialism (amount of emphasis placed on acquiring and owning products), self-consciousness (the degree to which a person deliberately monitors and controls the image of the self that is projected to others), and, need for cognition (the degree to which a person likes to think about things and by extension expend the necessary effort to process brand information). Thus, the approach tries to identify the dimensions and make up the personality of the consumer. This way, comparisons can be made over

the segments as well cultures. Marketers have used the approach quite often. For this purpose, a variety of personality scales have developed and employed.

Trait theory attempts to describe people in terms of their predispositions on a series of adjectives. Table 7.1 gives a list of sixteen traits on which a person can be described.

Many such lists have been developed. Researchers then use these trait inventories to investigate the personality profiles of groups of consumers of competing brands.

Table 7.1 Sixteen Personality Traits Identified by Cattell

1. Reserved vs Outgoing	9. Trusting vs Suspicious
2. Dull vs Bright	10. Practical vs Imaginative
3. Unstable vs Stable	11. Unpretentious vs Polished
4. Docile vs Aggressive	12. Self-assured vs Self-reproaching
5. Serious vs Happy-go-lucky	13. Conservative vs Experimenting
6. Expedient vs Conservative	14. Group Dependent vs Self-sufficient
7. Shy vs Uninhibited	15. Undisciplined vs Controlled
8. Tough minded vs Tender minded	16. Relaxed vs Tense

Trait theory is based on certain assumptions namely that:

- 1) Traits are relatively stable characteristics.
- 2) There are a limited number of traits common to most people. People differ in the extent to which they possess these common traits.
- 3) The degrees to which individuals possess certain traits can be measured by using a questionnaire. For example, a consumer may be viewed as possessing some degree of each trait along a continuum such as:

Trusting Versus Suspicious

Self-assured Versus Insecure

a) Trusting..... Suspicious

b) Self-assured Insecure

A rating toward the suspicious end of the continuum would indicate a much tougher customer than one toward the 'trusting' end. Similarly, a self-assured person would be more likely to try new products than an insecure customer. Again, dogmatic people are found to be less receptive to unfamiliar stimuli and to new styles and products.

Factor theories involve the application of Trait theory by subjecting large numbers of individuals to personality tests the results of which are subsequently analysed by a statistical technique called factor analysis. This enables common factors or traits to be identified in groups of people who constitute market segments.

This approach is however not without its limitations as given below:

- a) The theory requires a scale to measure these traits. Many of the scales are not sufficiently valid or reliable, they do not adequately measure what they are supposed to measure, and their results may not be stable over time.
- b) Personality tests are often developed for specific populations (e.g., mentally ill

people), these tests are then “borrowed” and applied to the general population where their relevance is questionable.

- c) The tests often are not administered under the appropriate conditions. Instance have been reported in the literature that often these tests have been given in a classroom or over a kitchen table by people who are not properly trained.
- d) The researchers often make changes in the instruments to adapt them to their own situations, in the process deleting or adding items and renaming variables. These ad hoc changes dilute the validity of the measures and also reduce researchers’ ability to compare results across consumer samples.
- e) Many trait scales are intended to measure gross, overall tendencies (e.g., emotional stability or introversion), these results are then used to make predictions about purchases of specific brands. Such attempts may be termed at best, ambitious.
- f) In many cases, a number of scales are given with no advance thought about how these measures should be related to consumer behaviour. The researchers then use a shotgun approach— following up on anything that happens to look interesting.

Activity 5

Do you agree with the above criticism of the trait theory of personality? What are the difficulties you are likely to encounter if you use the trait measures of personality to measure the personality of your consumers?

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7.8 THE THEORY OF SELF-CONCEPT

Self-concept is a concept related to personality as it draws much of its strength from the latter. Self-concept refers to ‘the attitude a person holds toward him—or herself’. Just as a consumer has an attitude toward a particular brand of soft drink or democracy, the self is also a subject of an attitude therefore, of evaluation. An overall self-attitude is frequently positive, but not always. There are certainly parts of the self that are evaluated more positively than others. For example, a consumer may consider himself more effective or articulate than the others.

Self-Concept Theory

This theory holds that individuals have a concept of self, based on who they think they are (the actual self) and a concept of who they think they would like to be (the ideal self). Self-concept theory is related to psychoanalytic theory since the actual self is similar to the ego and the ideal self is similar to the superego. Self-concept theory is governed by the desire to attain self-consistency and the desire to enhance one’s self esteem. Generally, consumers buy products that confirm to their actual self-image. But if they are low in self-esteem, they are more likely to buy based on what they would like to be rather than what they are.

Buying to achieve an unrealizable self-image can lead to compulsive purchasing behaviour. Frequent purchasing is a means to overcome the discrepancy between the real and ideal selves and to relieve a sense of low self-esteem.

Another dimension of self-concept theory is the extended self. Certain products have symbolic value and are considered an extension of our personality (eg, a car). This extension of self-concept theory in fact has been called symbolic interactionism because it emphasizes the interaction between individuals and the symbols in their environment.

Advertisers have understood the symbolic role of products in influencing self-image. Advertising for jewellery, cosmetics, automobiles and clothing frequently communicates an image of the user.

Compared to other attitudes, the self-concept is a very complex structure. It is composed of many attributes, some of which are given greater emphasis in determining overall self-attitude. Attributes of self-concept can be described along such dimensions as their content (e.g., facial attractiveness versus mental aptitude), positivity or negativity (i.e., self-esteem), intensity, stability over time, and accuracy (i.e., the degree to which one's self-assessment corresponds to reality). As will be seen later in the unit, consumers' self-assessments can be quite distorted, especially with regard to their physical appearance.

Activity 6

Talk to a group of your friends in terms of their brand selection of their watches, cars and formal shirts. When asked about why they chose that particular brand, assess how many of them attribute their selection to the brand being an expression of what they think they are.

In all such cases probe further to explore how their chosen brands reinforce their self concept.

Put down the results of your discussion here:

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7.9 THE RELATED CONCEPTS

Though personality and self-concept are now the essential terms in the marketing lexicon of today, they are not the only words that marketers use and manage in the process of relating their products to the image of the consumers and the products. The two words especially mentioned in the context are the self-consciousness and the self-esteem.

7.9.1 Self-consciousness

Unlike the feeling in self-concept, self-consciousness is more deliberate and easily felt or told. Thus, there are times when people seem to be painfully aware of

themselves. If you have ever walked into a class in the middle of lecture and noticed that all eyes were on you, you can understand this feeling of self-consciousness. In contrast, consumers sometimes behave with little self-consciousness. For example, people may do things in a stadium, a riot, or a fraternity party that they would never do if they were highly conscious of their behaviour.

In the marketing consumption context, some products do bring out self-consciousness in the customers while they are buying or considering them. Thus, 'esteem' products or the 'unmentionable products' make the customers very self-conscious of them. The rule of the thumb in this regard is that if a person is doing what he or she is not supposed to do in the normal course, it makes them conscious of themselves: It is both a marketing opportunity and a challenge.

7.9.2 Self-esteem

Self-esteem refers to the 'positivity of one's attitude toward oneself'. People with low self-esteem do not expect that they will perform very well. They thus, constantly endeavour to avoid embarrassment, failure, or rejection. In developing a new line of snack cakes, for example, a manufacturer found that consumers low in self-esteem, preferred portion-controlled (healthy amount) snack items because they felt they lacked self-control. In contrast, people with high self-esteem expect to be successful, will take more risks, spend more money on themselves, and are more willing to be the center of attention.

Self-esteem often is related to acceptance by others. For example, young persons who move in high-status "crowds in the disco bars" have higher self-esteem than their counterparts. Like the situation in the self-consciousness, the self-esteem too poses an opportunity to the marketers. For example, Dove's "Self-Esteem" campaign, which promotes realistic pictures of women, was developed in response to idealised and unrealistic depictions of women in advertising, which have been shown to reduce self-esteem.

Activity 7

Mention two campaigns in the consumer product category which are based on the self-consciousness and the self-confidence. Write your analysis in 15 to 25 words each.

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7.9.3 Multiple Selves

In a way, each consumer is really a number of different people. We have as many selves as we do different social roles. Depending upon the situation, we act differently, use different products and services, and even vary in terms of how much we like ourselves. A person may require a different set of products to play a desired role. She may choose a sedate, understated perfume when she is being her professional self, but splash on something more provocative on Saturday night as she becomes her 'femme fatale' self. Similarly, all Indians, how soever stern and proper they are

in dressing themselves in everyday life, have known to let their hair down on festival occasions.

The ‘dramaturgical perspective’ on consumer behaviour views people much like actors who play different roles. We each play many roles, and each has its own script, props, and costumes.

Depending on the characteristics of a situation and the other people with whom one is interacting, different roles are played. The self can be thought of as having different components or role identities, and only some of these are active at any given time.

Some identities (e.g., husband, boss, student) are more central to the self than others, but other identities (e.g., stamp collector, dancer, or advocate for the homeless) may be dominant in specific situations. For example, executives in a survey done in the United States, the United Kingdom, and some Pacific Rim countries said that different aspects of their personalities come into play depending on whether they are making purchase decisions at home or at work. Not surprisingly, they report being less time-conscious, more emotional, and less disciplined in their home roles.

7.9.4 Symbolic Interactionism

If each person potentially has many social selves, how does each develop and how do we decide which self to “activate” at any point in time? The sociological tradition of symbolic **Interactionism** stresses that relationships with other people play a part in forming the self. This **perspective** maintains that people exist in a symbolic environment and the meaning attached to any situation or object is determined by the interpretation of these symbols. As members of society, we learn to agree on shared meanings. Thus, we know that a red light means stop, the golden arches of McDonald mean fast food etc.

Like other social objects, the meanings of consumers themselves are defined by social consensus. The consumer interprets his or her own identity, and this assessment is continually evolving as he or she encounters new situations and people. In symbolic interactionist terms, we negotiate these meanings over time. Essentially the consumer poses the question: “Who am I in this situation?” The answer to this question is greatly influenced by those around us: “Who do other people think I am?” We tend to pattern our behaviour on the perceived expectations of others in a form of self-fulfilling prophecy. By acting the way, we assume others expect us to act, we wind up confirming this perception.

Activity 8

Explain the concept of symbolic interactionism in your own words and illustrate the concept with right example.

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7.9.5 The Looking-Glass Self

This process of imagining the reactions of others toward us is known as “taking the role of the other,” or the “looking-glass self.” According to this view, a process

of reflexive evaluation occurs when the individual attempts to define the self, and it operates as a sort of psychological sonar: We take readings of our own identity by “bouncing” signals off of others. The looking-glass image we receive will differ depending upon whose views we are considering. Like the distorted mirrors in a fun-house, our appraisal of who we are can vary, depending upon whose perspective we are taking. A confident career woman may sit morosely at a night club, imagining that others see her as an unattractive woman with little sex appeal (whether these perceptions are true or not).

7.10 CONSUMPTION AND SELF-CONCEPT

By extending the dramaturgical perspective a bit further, it is easy to see how the consumption of products and services contributes to the definition of the self. For an actor to play a role convincingly, he or she needs the correct props, stage setting, and so on. Consumers learn that different roles are accompanied by constellations of products and activities that help to define these roles. Some “props” are so important to the roles we play that they can be viewed as a part of the extended self, a concept to be discussed shortly.

The use of consumption information to define the self is especially important when an identity is yet to be adequately formed, as occurs when a consumer plays a new or unfamiliar role. Symbolic self-completion theory predicts that people who have an incomplete self-definition tend to complete this identity by displaying symbols associated with it. For example, the clothing ad may emphasize the perspective that the confidence one gains by wearing the right fashions. Adolescent boys may use “macho” products like sports bike and cars to bolster their developing masculinity; here, products are a sort of “social crutch” to be leaned upon during a period of uncertainty.

7.10.1 Self Image-Product Image Congruence

Because many consumption activities are related to self-definition, it is not surprising to learn that consumers demonstrate consistency between their values and attitudes and the things they buy. Self-image congruence models predict that products will be chosen when their attributes match some aspect of the self. These models assume a process of cognitive matching between these attributes and the consumer’s self-image. While results are somewhat mixed, the ideal self appears to be more relevant as a comparison standard for highly expressive social products such as perfume. In contrast, actual self is more relevant for every day, functional products. These standards are also likely to vary by usage situation. For example, a consumer might want a functional, reliable car to commute to work everyday, but a flashier model with more “zing” when going out on a social date in the evening.

Activity 9

Explain the concept of self image – brand image congruence in your own words and illustrate the concept with right example.

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7.10.2 The Extended Self

As noted earlier, many of the props and settings consumers use to define their social roles or sense become a part of their selves. Those external objects that we consider a part of us comprise the extended self. In some cultures, people literally incorporate objects into the self: they lick new possessions, take the names of conquered enemies (or in some cases eat them), or bury the dead with their possessions. Four levels of the extended self are used by consumers to define themselves. These range from very personal objects to places and things, that allow people to feel like they are rooted in their environments.

- a) **Individual level:** Consumers include many of their personal possessions in self-definition. These products can include jewellery, cars, clothing, perfume and so on. The saying “You are what you wear” reflects the belief that one’s things are a part of what one is.
- b) **Family level:** This part of the extended self includes a consumer’s residence and the furnishings in it. The house can be thought of as a symbolic body of the family and is often a central aspect of identity.
- c) **Community level:** It is common for consumers to describe themselves in terms of the neighbourhood or town from which they come. For farm families or residents with close ties to a community, this sense of belonging is particularly important.
- d) **Group level:** Our attachments to certain social groups also can be considered a part of self. A consumer may feel that marks, landmarks, monuments, or sports teams are a part of the extended self.

Activity 10

Explain the concept of self-extension in your own words and illustrate the concept with right example.

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7.10.3 Digital Self

Mobile based applications allow virtually anyone to modify his or her digital self. We can modify our profile photos or description that we post or share on social networking sites. In addition, someone can create additional identities in virtual worlds like *Second Life* and massive multiplayer online games (MMOGs) such as *World of Warcraft*. The digital environment is changing the established concept of “you are what you wear” to “you are what you post.”. One study revealed that respondents have given more value to digital items that reflect their physical identities, such as digital photos and written communications. It also has been reported that the digital self may actually be a projection of one’s fantasy about himself or herself. It is as if a person had the freedom to create a persona and goes ahead to exercise that freedom. Like the concept of multiple self studied above, avid users of digital media have been known to create multiple identities.

Activity 11

How might the “digital self” differ from a consumer’s self-concept in the real world, and why is this difference potentially important to marketers?

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7.11 SUMMARY

The unit makes an attempt to answer how and why marketers have to address themselves to the issues of personality and self-image and the influence these variable have on consumption. The main reason is that consumers seek a congruence in what they are and what the products may mean to them. Three theories of personality are explained in the unit. They are psychoanalytic theory of personality, social theory and the trait theory. Trait theory has been advocated to be the most implementable. Then the unit moves to the issue of self-image and self-concept and explains variations across which these concepts get applied. The unit also describes how a level of ‘Interactionism’ occurs among the various types of self.

7.12 KEY WORDS

- Congruity theory** : a consistency theory that specifically allows a linkage between a self-concept and the product concept.
- Personality** : “a person’s unique psychological make up that allows him to respond in a consistent manner”.
- Self-concept** : The attitude that a person holds towards himself or herself.
- Self-image theory** : a theory based on the congruence between the attributes of one self and that of the product.
- Trait** : The identifiable characteristics that define a person.
- Symbolic** : a sociological perspective that holds that relationships with other people play a large part in forming the self.
- Interactionism**

7.13 SELF-ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

- 1) Define personality. What are the differences of the trait and the psychoanalytic theory of personality? How do marketers apply their understanding of these theories
- 2) Elucidate the concept of symbolic INTERACTIONISM. How does it help the marketers?
- 3) Do the theories of personality and self-concept have a global relevance? if not, make a list of the products and services to which they readily apply?

- 4) What are the marketing implications of the 'extended self' concept? Prepare a framework for its application.
- 5) Compare and contrast the real versus the ideal self. List three products for which a person is likely to use each type of self as a reference point when he or she considers a purchase.

7.14 PROJECT QUESTIONS

1. Select the advertisement of the Passenger Car brands in India and try to glean out the personality they seem to project. Make a chart of these personalities identifying the key features of each personality. Then make a sample of owners of these brands. Compare the two and write your assessment as to what extent these two agree.
2. Construct a "consumption biography" of a friend or family member. Make a list of or photograph his or her favourite possessions, and see if you or others can describe this person's personality just from the information provided by this catalogue.

7.15 FURTHER READINGS

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5. Calvin Springer Hall Gardner Lindzey John B. Campbell , Theories of Personality Wiley India Pvt. Ltd, 2008
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UNIT 8 CONSUMER MOTIVATION AND INVOLVEMENT

Learning Outcomes

After having gone through this unit, you should be able to:

- explain the concept of consumer motivation
- discuss the linkage among the consumer motivation, involvement and consumer decision-making
- identify the problems as well as solution for measuring consumer motivation and involvement, and
- discuss the marketing approaches and strategies to influence consumer motivation and involvement.
- apply your knowledge of consumer motivation and involvement in your marketing decisions

Structure

- 8.1 Introduction
- 8.2 The Concept and Typology of Needs
- 8.3 Theories of Consumer Needs
- 8.4 Motives: The Basis of Motivation
- 8.5 The Concept of Motivation
- 8.6 Motivational Conflicts
- 8.7 Consumer Involvement
- 8.8 The Facets of Involvement
- 8.9 Summary
- 8.10 Key Words
- 8.11 Self-assessment Questions
- 8.12 Project Questions
- 8.13 Further Readings

Advent of internet technology has transformed the business operations. It has made the consumers' life more convenient and easier by providing online marketing opportunities. Consumers can compare the various features of competitive products online and may order for online purchase from the comfort of his/her home. Online payments can be done with the help of internet banking, Credit/ Debit card, UPI, e-wallets (digital wallets or mobile wallets). In India demonetization and pandemic covid-19 has expedited the use of digital payment and accelerated the adoption of e Commerce. Moreover, discount on payments made through digital mode are offered for many transactions. For example, the 0.75 per cent discount on payment made by digital mode is offered for petrol and diesel; discount of Rs 50 per gram from the issue price of sovereign

gold bond was offered to those investors who applied online and the payment was made through digital mode. These are almost fundamental changes to how consumers decide and buy and influence many variables affecting buying decisions, including consumer motivation and involvement, the subject matter of this unit.

8.1 INTRODUCTION

Why do we buy one product or brand rather than the other? Why do we buy from one shop than the other or use online browsing to identify our choices? Why do we buy at all?

The questions may sound as the platitudes to some of us, axiomatic to the others. But the real reason is to underscore a basic point of human behaviour. You would recall that in the first unit of this course we had defined human behaviour as motivated or goal-oriented. Some of us may not have realized it this way but it still is true. The chief characteristic of the human actions is that each and every part of it is guided by motives: conscious or otherwise. A successful marketer understands the motives and “shapes them”.

However, the strength of the motive may not be very strong for the comfort or the discomfort of the marketer. This may be either because consumers are not aware of the importance of the buying decision or that, there was no need or occasion for the marketer to address the consumers on the importance of the decision that the consumers make for themselves. A time comes for the marketer when they have to add some of their own strength to these motivations to facilitate consumer action to reach the desired goal. This is known as the process of creating consumer involvement.

8.2 THE CONCEPT AND TYPOLOGY OF NEEDS

Consumer motivation and involvement are based primarily on the notions of consumer needs and wants. The section aims to discuss the concept of need and extend your understanding of what you have already covered in your core course MMPC-006.

8.2.1 Concept of Need

The concept of need and its typology have a long history and the meaning is far from clear. Several terms like need, want and demand are used in the similar context. Thus, the particular form of consumption used to satisfy a need is termed a want. The specific way a need is satisfied depends upon the individual's unique history, learning experiences, and his or her cultural environment. For example, two course mates in a training programme, one Indian and the other French, may feel their stomachs rumbling during a lunchtime lecture. If neither person has eaten since the night before, the strength of their respective needs (hunger) would be about the same.

However, the way each person goes about satisfying this need might be quite different. The first person may be aroused by prospect of a Parantha and *pakauris*, the second person may be satisfied with cottage cheese, bread and milk. The distinction between needs and wants is important because it relates to the issue of whether marketers are actually capable of creating needs.

A need in consumer behaviour context is defined as a state of felt deprivation that impels action to rectify that state. So in the above example, owing to the gap between their last meal and now, both classmates experience a state of food deprivation or are in need of food. The physiological discomfort of this hunger will activate them to look for and consume food. However while both 'need' food, they 'want' significantly different satisfiers. The marketers are very aware that the same need for different target segments may translate into very different wants which they can then apply to their marketing mix decisions.

Activity 1

Give one example from your own consumption that bring out the difference between the need and want.

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8.2.2 Types of Needs

People are born with a need for certain elements necessary to maintain life, such as food, water, air and shelter. These are called biogenic needs. People have many other needs, however, that are not innate. Psychogenic needs are, acquired in the process of becoming a member of a culture. These include the need for status, power, affiliation, and so on. For example, that an Indian consumer may be driven to devote a good chunk of his income to products that permit him to satisfy his concern for the family, shows an example of psychogenic needs. Consumers can also be motivated to satisfy either utilitarian or hedonic needs. The satisfaction of utilitarian needs implies that consumers will emphasize the objective, tangible attributes of products, such as durability in a home appliance, fuel economy in a car etc. Hedonic needs are subjective and experiential. Consumers may rely on a product to meet their needs for excitement, self-confidence, fantasy, and so on. Of course, consumers may be motivated to purchase a product because it provides both types of benefits. For example, X brand of car may be bought because it feels well styled, and luxurious and also because it keeps the cost of running the car low.

8.3 THEORIES OF CONSUMER NEEDS

Much research has been done on classifying human needs. On the one hand, some psychologists have tried to define a universal inventory of needs that could be traced systematically to explain virtually all behaviour. One such effort, developed by Henry Murray, delineates a set of twenty needs that (sometimes in combination) result in specific behaviours. These needs include such dimensions as *autonomy* (being independent), *defendance* (defending the self against criticism), and even *play* (engaging in pleasurable activities). Others have focused on specific needs (which often are included in general models like Murray's) and their ramifications for

behaviour. For example, individuals with a high need for achievement strongly value personal accomplishment. They place a premium on products and services that signify success because these consumption items provide feedback about the realization of their goals. These consumers are good prospects for products that provide evidence of their achievement. One study of working women found that those who were high in achievement motivation, were more likely to choose clothing they considered business like, and less likely to be interested in apparel or accessories that accentuated their femininity. Some other important needs that are relevant to consumer behaviour include the following.

- a) **Need for affiliation** (to be in the company of other people): This need is relevant to products and services that are consumed in groups and alleviate loneliness, such as team sports, bars, and shopping and social clubs.
- b) **Need for power** (to control one's environment): Many products and services allow consumers to feel that they have mastery over their surroundings. The use of the i-phones or apple smart watches, powerful all terrain SUVs, high end laptops, and enabling software is the example of products targeted at such needs.
- c) **Need for uniqueness** (to assert one's individual identity): This need is satisfied by products that promise to accentuate a consumer's distinctive qualities. For example, fashion clothing, athletic shoes, perfumes and books.

Activity 2

Give one example each from consumption seen around you that bring out the difference between various needs as mentioned above.

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- d) **Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs:** One widely accepted approach to motivation was proposed by the psychologist Abraham Maslow. Maslow's approach is a general one originally developed to understand personal growth and the attainment of "peak experiences." Maslow formulated a hierarchy of needs, in which levels of motives are specified. A hierarchical approach implies that the order of development is fixed-that is, a certain level must be attained before the next, higher one is activate. This universal approach to motivation has been adapted by marketers because it (indirectly) specifies certain types of product benefits people might be looking for, depending upon the different stages in their development and/or their environmental conditions. These levels are summarized in Figure 8.1. At each level, different priorities exist in terms of the product benefits a consumer is looking for. Ideally, an individual progresses up the hierarchy until his or her dominant motivation is a focus on "ultimate" goals, such as justice and beauty. Unfortunately, this state is difficult to achieve (at least on a regular basis, most of us have to be satisfied with occasional glimpses, or peak experiences.

Figure 8.1

Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs



(<https://commons.wikimedia.org/wiki/File:Maslows-Hierarchy-of-Needs-1.png>)

Examples of product appeals tailored to each level are provided in Table 8.1.

Table 8.1

Level of Hierarchy	Relevant Products	Example
Self-actualization	Hobbies, travel, education, contribution for a greater good	New Education Policy 2020 "Educate Encourage Enlighten"
Self-esteem needs	Car, furniture	Toyota – Corolla "A car to be proud of"
Social needs	Clothing, grooming products, social community	Facebook "Connect with the friends and the world around you"
Safety needs	Insurance, investment, alarm system	Life Insurance Corporation of India "Zindagi Ke Saath Bhi Zindagi Ke Baad Bhi"
Physiological needs	Food, medicines, staple items, generics	Online food ordering and delivery platform Zomato "Never have a bad meal", Maggie; appeal –fast to cook, good to eat

Activity 3

Give one example from your own consumption that illustrate the meaning of the five levels of Maslow's hierarchy of needs.

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- e) **The implication of Maslow's hierarchy** is that one must first satisfy basic needs before progressing up the ladder (i.e., a starving man is not interested in status symbols, friendship, or self-fulfilment). This hierarchy should however not be seen as inflexible. Its use in marketing has been somewhat simplistic, especially since the same product or activity can satisfy a number of different needs. Sex, for example, is characterized as a basic biological drive. While this observation is true throughout most of the animal kingdom, it is obviously a more complicated phenomenon for humans. Indeed, this activity could conceivably fit into every level of Maslow's hierarchy. Another problem with taking Maslow's hierarchy too literally is that it is culture-bound. The assumptions of the hierarchy may be restricted to Western culture. People in other cultures (or, for that matter, in eastern culture) may question the order of the levels as specified. A religious person who has taken a vow of celibacy, would not necessarily agree that physiological needs must be satisfied for self-fulfilment to occur. Similarly, many eastern cultures operate on the premise that the welfare of the group (social or belongingness needs) is more highly valued than needs of the individual (esteem needs). The point is that this hierarchy, while widely applied in marketing, should be valued because it reminds us that consumers may have different need priorities at different time (i.e., you have to walk before you can run) rather than because it exactly specifies a consumer's progression up the ladder of needs.

Activity 4

Do you think needs always operate in a hierarchical fashion? List any limitations of the Maslow's hierarchy of needs when seen in the Indian context.

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8.4 MOTIVES: THE BASIS OF MOTIVATION

A motive is an underlying reason for behaviour and not something researchers can see or easily measure. Furthermore, the same behaviour can be caused by a number of different motives. To compound the problem of identifying motives, the consumer may be unaware of the actual need he or she is attempting to satisfy, or alternatively he or she may not be willing to admit that this need exists. Because of these difficulties, motives usually must be inferred by the analyst. Although some consumer needs undoubtedly are utilitarian and fairly straightforward, some researchers feel that a great many purchase decisions are not the result of deliberate, logical decisions.

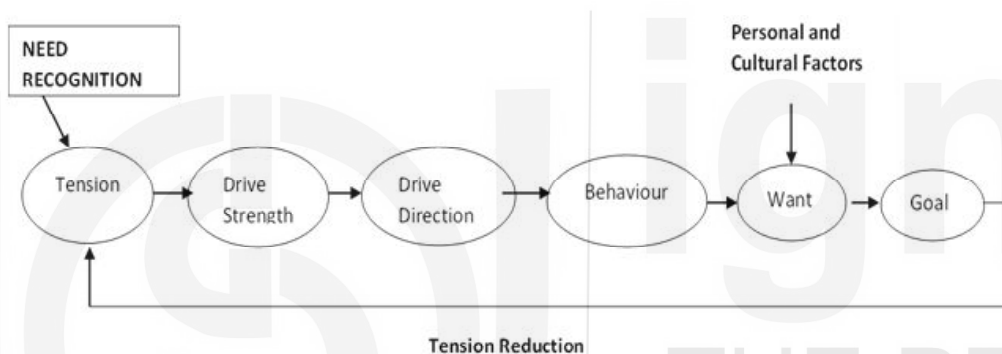
To the contrary, people may do things to satisfy motives of which they are not even aware.

8.5 THE CONCEPT OF MOTIVATION

Motivation refers to ‘the processes that cause people to behave as they do’. It occurs when a need is aroused that the consumer wishes to satisfy. Once a need has been activated, a state of tension exists that drives the consumer to attempt to reduce or eliminate the tension. Marketers try to create products and services that will provide the desired benefits and permit the consumer to reduce this tension, by going in for consumption or acquisition of the products/services.

Figure 8.2 gives an overview of the motivation process. The sections to follow will elaborate on the components in this model, but in general the process works the way as described below.

Figure 8.2: An Overview of the Motivation Process



Alternatively, motivation has been defined as the inner drive in individuals which impels them to action

8.5.1 Goal

A need is recognized by the consumer. This need may be utilitarian (i.e., a desire to achieve some functional or practical benefit, as when a person requires a pair of durable sneakers) or it may be hedonic (i.e., an experiential need, involving emotional responses or fantasies). The desired state as an expected outcome of the buying action is the consumer's goal.

8.5.2 Drive

In either case, a discrepancy exists between the consumer's present state and some ideal state. This gulf creates a state of tension. The magnitude of this tension determines the urgency the consumer feels to reduce the tension. This degree of arousal is called a drive.

8.5.3 Want

As mentioned earlier, a basic need can be satisfied any number of ways, and the specific path a person chooses is influenced by his or her unique set of experiences, cultural upbringing, and so on. These factors combine to create a want, which is one, the specific manifestation of a need.

Activity 5

Give one example from your own consumption experience that brings out the components of consumer motivation process.

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8.5.4 Theories of Motivation

There are several principles on which the motivation theory is based. Some of them are explained below:

a) Instinct Theory of Motivation

Early work on motivation ascribed behaviour to instinct-the innate patterns of behaviour that are universal in species. This view is now largely discredited. For one thing, the existence of an instinct is difficult to prove or disprove. It is like saying that a consumer buys status symbols because he or she is motivated to attain status, which is hardly a satisfying explanation.

b) Drive Theory

Drive theory focuses on biological needs that produce unpleasant states of arousal (e.g., your stomach grumbles during a morning class). We are motivated to reduce the tension caused by this arousal. Tension reduction has been proposed as a basic mechanism governing human behaviour. In marketing, tension refers to the unpleasant state that exists if a person's needs are not fulfilled. A person maybe irritable if he hasn't eaten, or he may be dejected or angry if he cannot afford that new car he wants. This state activates goal-oriented behaviour, which attempts to reduce or eliminate this unpleasant state and return to a balanced one, is termed homeostasis.

Drive theory, however, runs into difficulties when it tries to explain some facets of human behaviour that run counter to its predictions. People often do things that increase a drive state rather than decrease it. For example, people may delay gratification. If you know you are going out for a lavish dinner, you might decide to forego a snack earlier in the day even though you are hungry at that time. In other cases, people deliberately watch erotic movies, even though these stimuli often increase sexual arousal rather than diminish it.

c) Expectancy Theory

Expectancy theory of motivation focus on cognitive factors rather than biological ones to understand what drives behaviour. Expectancy theory suggests that behaviour is largely pulled by expectations of achieving desirable outcomes - positive incentives, rather than pushed from within. We choose one product over another because we expect this choice to have more positive consequences for us. Thus, the term drive is used here more loosely to refer to both physical and cognitive processes.

Activity 6

Write three key words for each of the theories of motivation:

a) Instinct Theory of Motivation

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b) Drive Theory

.....

c) Expectancy Theory

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8.5.5 Motivational Strength

Once the goal is attained, tension is reduced and the motivation recedes (for the time being). Motivation can be described in terms of its strength, or the pull it exerts on the consumer, and its direction, or the particular way the consumer attempts to reduce motivational tension. Motivational strength is “the degree to which a person is willing to expend energy to reach one goal as opposed to another”. It reflects his or her underlying motivation to attain that goal. Many theories have been advanced to explain why people behave the way they do. Most share the basic idea that people have some finite amount of energy that must be directed toward certain goals.

8.5.6 Motivational Direction

Motives have direction as well as strength. They are goal-oriented in that specific objectives are desired to satisfy a need. Most goals can be reached by a number of routes, and the objective of marketers is to convince consumers that the alternative they offer provides the best chance to attain the goal. For example, a consumer who decides that he needs a pair of jeans to help him reach his goal of being accepted by others or projecting an appropriate image can choose among Levi’s, Wranglers, Flying Machine, or the like, each of which promises to deliver certain comfort or style or social benefits.

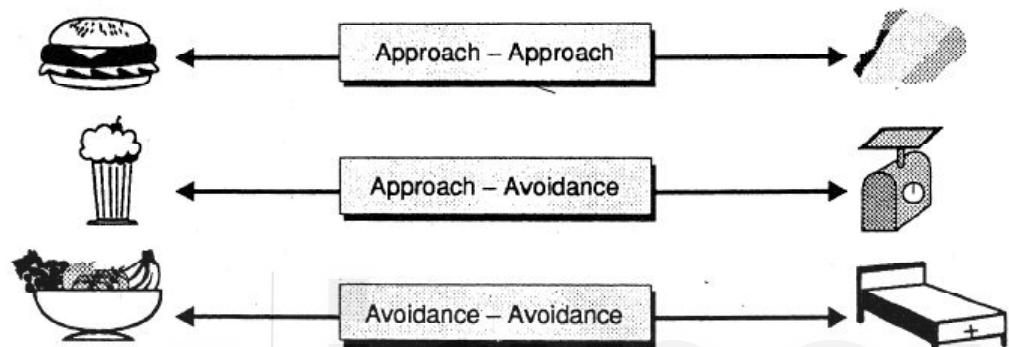
Valence, popularly known as the direction, of the goal or the purpose can be positive or negative, which will in turn make the consumer goals as the negative or positive goals. A positive valence goal is one toward which consumers direct their behaviour, they are motivated to approach the goal and will seek out product that will be instrumental in attaining it. For example, a consumer may use the exercise equipment called, Allegro, to help him achieve the positive goal of improving his physique and social appearance.

However, not all behaviour is motivated by the desire to approach a goal. In other cases, consumers are instead motivated to avoid a negative outcome. They will structure their purchases or consumption activities to reduce the chances of attaining this end result. For example, many consumers work hard to avoid rejection, a negative goal. They will stay away from products that they associate with social disapproval. Products such as deodorants and mouthwash frequently rely upon consumers’ negative motivation by depicting the onerous social consequences of underarm odour or bad breath.

8.6 MOTIVATIONAL CONFLICT'S

A purchase decision may involve more than one source of motivation. Consumers often find themselves in situations where different motives, both positive and negative, conflict with one another, since marketers are attempting to satisfy consumers' needs, they can also be helpful by providing possible solutions to these dilemmas. As shown in Figure 8.3, three general types of conflicts can occur: approach-approach, approach-avoidance, and avoidance-avoidance.

Figure 8.3 Three Types of Motivational Conflicts



8.6.1 Approach-Approach Conflict

Here, a person must choose between two desirable alternatives. A student might be torn between going home for the holidays or going on with friends for a sightseeing trip. Or, he or she might have to choose between two equally desired books but only one can be bought with the limited funds that they have.

8.6.2 Approach-Avoidance Conflict

Many of the product and services we desire have negative consequences attached to them as well. We may feel guilty or ostentatious when buying ice creams or expensive perfume. Some solutions to these conflicts include the proliferation of low-fat ice creams, which eliminate guilt about unhealthy but pleasurable food choices, and the success of diet foods, such as Weight Watchers, that promise good food without the calories. Many marketers try to overcome guilt by convincing consumers that they are deserving of luxuries, as in case of L'Oréal personal care for women "because you are worth it".

The conflict of this kind gives rise to another consumer behaviour concept, called cognitive dissonance. The theory of cognitive dissonance is based on the premise that people have a need for order and consistency in their lives and that a state of tension is created when beliefs or behaviours conflict with one another. A state of dissonance occurs when there is a logical inconsistency between two or more beliefs or behaviours. It often occurs when a consumer must make a choice between two products, where both alternatives usually possess both good and bad qualities. By choosing one product and not the other, the person gets the bad qualities of the chosen product and loses out on the good qualities of the unchosen one. This loss creates an unpleasant, dissonant state that the person is motivated to reduce. The conflict that arises when choosing between two alternatives may be resolved through a process of cognitive dissonance reduction, in which people are motivated to reduce this inconsistency (or dissonance) and thus, eliminate unpleasant tension. People tend to convince themselves after the fact that the choice they made was the smart one by finding additional reasons to support the decision on alternative they chose,

or perhaps by “discovering” flaws with the option they did not choose. A marketer can resolve an approach-avoidance conflict by bundling several benefits together. For example, a person may have to accept an attractive job offer with handsome salary, but at the same time he perceives that the job is very risky.

Activity 7

Give one example how you will meet the threat of cognitive dissonance in respect of buying trousers, candies, potato chips, etc.

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8.6.3 Avoidance-Avoidance Conflict

Sometimes consumers find themselves caught “between a rock and hard place.” They may face a choice with two undesirable alternatives. A person may be faced with the option of either throwing more money into an old car or buying a new car. Marketers frequently address this conflict by message that stress the unforeseen benefits of choosing one option (e.g., by emphasizing lease finance or easy payment plans to ease the pain of new-car payments). Similarly, the problem of remaining unemployed or taking up a job which is either life threatening or socially low esteem. Medicine buying is another example of this type of conflict wherein the relief sought may be counterbalanced either by the exorbitant price of possible side effects.

8.7 CONSUMER INVOLVEMENT

Along with the concept of motivation, involvement is another concept central to activating consumer motives. Involvement refers to “the level of perceived personal importance and/or interest evoked by a stimulus (or stimuli) within a specific situation”.

This definition implies that aspects of the person, the product, and the situation all combine to determine the consumer’s motivation to process product related information at a given point in time. When consumers are intent on doing what they can to satisfy a need, they will be motivated to pay attention and process any information felt to be relevant to achieving their goals. On the other hand, a person may not bother to pay any attention to the same information it is not seen as relevant to satisfying some need. One person who prides himself on his knowledge of exercise equipment may read anything he can find about the subject, spend his spare time in athletics stores, and so on, while another (lazier) person may skip over this information without giving it a second thought.

Involvement can also be linked to the motivation to process information. To the degree that there is a perceived linkage between a consumer’s needs, goals, or values, and product knowledge, the consumer will be motivated to pay attention to product information. When relevant knowledge is activated in memory, a motivational state is created that drives behaviour (e.g., shopping). This subjective feeling of personal relevance is termed felt involvement. As felt involvement with a product increases people devote more attention to ads related to the product, exert more cognitive effort to understand these ads, and focus their attention on the product-

related information in them. They may also become more cognitively engaged in evaluating alternatives, carefully processing all available information and seeking references from existing users

Degree of involvement can be conceived as a continuum, ranging from absolute lack of interest in a marketing stimulus at one end to obsession at the other. Consumption of the low end of involvement is characterized by inertia, where decisions are made out of habit because the consumer lacks the motivation to consider alternatives. At the high end of involvement, we can expect to find the type of passionate intensity reserved for people and objects that carry great meaning to the individual. Involvement thus affects the information processing and activation. Thus, type of information processing depends upon the consumer's level of involvement. It can range from simple processing, where only the basic features of a message are considered to the one all the way to elaboration, where the incoming information is linked to one's pre-existing knowledge systems.

Activity 8

Define in your way the term of involvement. Indicate whether in general, level of involvement will be higher or lower in the following products?

- 1) Newspaper
- 2) Mixer and grinder
- 3) Salt
- 4) Toothpaste

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8.8 THE FACETS OF INVOLVEMENT

As previously defined, involvement can take many forms. A consumer could certainly be said to be involved with a pair of running shoes if they help to define and bolster his self-concept. This involvement seems to increase at certain times, as when he must prove himself in a competition. Alternatively, the act of buying the shoes may be very involving for people who are passionately devoted to shopping. To complicate matters further, advertisements, such as those produced for Nike or Adidas, may themselves become involving for some reason (e.g., because they make us laugh, cry, or inspire us to work harder or use our favourite sports icon saying something very relevant to our related need).

8.8.1 Types of Involvement

It seems that involvement is a fuzzy concept, because it overlaps with other things and means different things to different people. Indeed, the consensus is that there are actually several broad types of involvement.

- a) **Purchase Involvement.** Purchase involvement is related to a consumer's level of interest in the buying process that is triggered by the need to consider a particular purchase. Many sales promotions are designed to increase purchase

- b) **Message-Response Involvement.** Message-response involvement refers to the processing of marketing communication. Television is considered a low involvement medium, because it requires a passive viewer who exerts relatively little control (remote control “zipping” notwithstanding) over content. In contrast, print is high-involvement medium. The reader is actively involved in processing the information and is able to pause and reflect on what he or she has read before moving on.
- c) **Ego Involvement.** Ego involvement, sometimes termed enduring involvement, refers to the importance of a product to a consumer’s self-concept. This concept implies a high level of social risk, the prospect of the product not performing its desired function may result in embarrassment or damage to the consumer’s self- concept. For example, the consumer’s formal jacket is clearly an important part of his self-identity as it enables him to project a desired persona. This type of involvement is independent of particular purchase situations.

Can you add to the typology of consumer involvement? If yes, in what they are important for the study of Consumers.

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The measurement of involvement is important for many marketing applications. For example, research evidence indicates that a viewer who is more involved with a television show, will also respond more positively to commercials contained in that show, and that these spots will have a greater chance of influencing his or her purchase intentions. The many conceptualizations of involvement have led to some confusion about the best way to measure the concept. The scale shown in Table 8.2 is one widely used method.

important		unimportant*
of no concern		of concern to me
irrelevant		relevant
means a lot to me		means nothing to me*

**Individual Influences on
Buying Behaviour**

useless	_: _: _: _: _: _: _:	useful
valuable	_: _: _: _: _: _: _:	worthless*
trivial	_: _: _: _: _: _: _:	fundamental
beneficial	_: _: _: _: _: _: _:	not beneficial*
matters to me	_: _: _: _: _: _: _:	doesn't matter*
uninterested	_: _: _: _: _: _: _:	interested
significant	_: _: _: _: _: _: _:	insignificant*
vital	_: _: _: _: _: _: _:	superfluous
boring	_: _: _: _: _: _: _:	interesting
unexciting	_: _: _: _: _: _: _:	exciting
appealing	_: _: _: _: _: _: _:	unappealing*
mundane	_: _: _: _: _: _: _:	fascinating
essential	_: _: _: _: _: _: _:	not essential*
undesirable	_: _: _: _: _: _: _:	desirable
wanted	_: _: _: _: _: _: _:	unwanted*
not needed	_: _: _: _: _: _: _:	needed

Activity 10

Review the above methodology and write your impression as follows:

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8.8.3 Development of Involvement Profile

A pair of French researchers have argued that no single component of involvement is predominant. Recognizing that consumers can be involved with a product because it is a risky purchase and/or its use reflects upon or affects the self, they advocate the development of an involvement profile containing four components.

- Importance and risk (the perceived importance of the product and the consequences of bad purchase)
- Probability of making a bad purchase
- Pleasure value of the product category
- Sign value of the product category

Activity 11

Do you agree with the argument for the development of an involvement profile?
Explain your answer.

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8.8.4 Segmenting by Involvement Levels

A measurement approach of this nature allows consumer researchers to capture the diversity of the involvement construct, and it also provides the potential to use involvement as a basis for market segmentation. For example, a tooth brush manufacturer might find that even though its product is low in sign value for one group of consumers, it might be highly related to the self-concept of another market segment, such as health enthusiasts or avid socializers. The company could adapt its strategy to account for the motivation of different segments to process information about the product. Note also that involvement with a product class may vary across cultures. While a sample of French consumers rated champagne high in both sign value and personal value, the ability of champagne to provide pleasure or be central to self-definition might not transfer to other countries (e.g. Islamic cultures).

8.8.5 Strategies to Increase Involvement

Although consumers differ in their level of involvement with respect to a product message, marketers do not have to just sit back and hope for the best. By being aware of some basic factors that increase or decrease attention, they can take steps to increase the likelihood that product information will get through and the resulting evaluation will favour their own brand. A consumer's motivation to process relevant information can be enhanced fairly easily by the marketer who uses one or more of the techniques as mentioned in this section, when designing persuasive communications. To take a common example, common salt which is typically a low involvement product has been often converted by marketers into a high-involvement buying one situation, by introducing variants like Iodised (Tata salt), free flowing (Catch), containing 20 plus minerals (Himalayan)

Activity 12

Mention four strategies for increasing the purchase involvement of the product
“ Air Conditioner”: -

Strategy 1

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Strategy 2

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Strategy 3.....

.....

Strategy 4.....

.....

8.9 SUMMARY

The unit raises two very important constructs in consumer behaviour. The first relates to the very basis of buying i.e., motive. The unit defines the motive as the goal or purpose of doing what the consumer does. It is the role of the marketer to find out what could possibly be the motive or provide one if the consumer does not seem to have one. The process of motivation is guided by a variety of principles ranging from instinctive theory to the cognitive or the balance theory of motivation. The second issue is that of involvement in buying. The term refers to the energy level felt or perceived by the consumer in buying that forces the consumer to participate in the process of decision making. The involvement too, again could be of several types and the marketer can exploit them or activate them with persuasive message. The unit also describes a process of measuring involvement.

8.10 KEY WORDS

Cognitive Dissonance: A state of tension created when the beliefs or behaviour conflict with one another.

Drive: The desire to satisfy a biological need.

Ego Involvement: The importance of the purchase to the self-concept of the consumer

Expectancy Theory: “The perspective that the behaviour is largely pulled by the expectations of achieving the desirable outcomes.

Involvement: The perceived personal importance of a given stimulus for a buyer in a given situation.

Inertia: The process by which the decisions are made out of habit without engaging in information search or alternative evaluation.

Motivation: An internal state that activates the goal related behaviour.

Perceived risk: The belief that the use of a product has potentially negative consequences.

8.11 SELF-ASSESSMENT QUESTIONS

- 1) Define the term consumer motive. Do the psychogenic motives have superiority over the physiological ones? Use examples to justify your answer
- 2) Critically analyse the Maslow’s hierarchy of needs theory. What are its major limitations?

- 3) What is motivation and why is this idea so important to marketers?
- 4) Describe three types of motivational conflicts with example of each from a contemporary marketing campaign of your choice.
- 5) Why involvement is so essential for the consumer behaviourist and marketers? Can it have a bearing over the brand preferences?
- 6) What are some strategies marketers can use to increase consumers' involvement with their products?

8.12 PROJECT QUESTIONS

1. Our online behaviours also can satisfy needs at different levels of Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs, when we participate in social networks such as YouTube, Facebook.
 - (a) What needs do these sites appear to satisfy? Enlist in view of Maslow's hierarchy of needs
 - (b) Identify new product ideas for social media
2. Identify five advertisement that in your opinion seek to
 - (a) activate the reasons for purchase and
 - (b) raise the level of involvement in the purchase. Now compare these attempts with what has been mentioned in the unit as the strategies.

8.13 FURTHER READINGS

1. Kotler, P., Keller, K.L., Koshy, A. and Jha, M. (2018), Marketing Management: A South Asian Perspective, Pearson Education.
2. Schiffman, L.G., Wisenblit, J., and Ramesh, K.S. (2018) "Consumer Behaviour", Twelfth edition, Pearson Education.
3. Solomon, M.R. (2018) "Consumer Behaviour: Buying, Having, and Being" Twelfth edition, Pearson Education.

